

# 50.039 Theory and Practice of Deep Learning

## Course Introduction

Matthieu De Mari

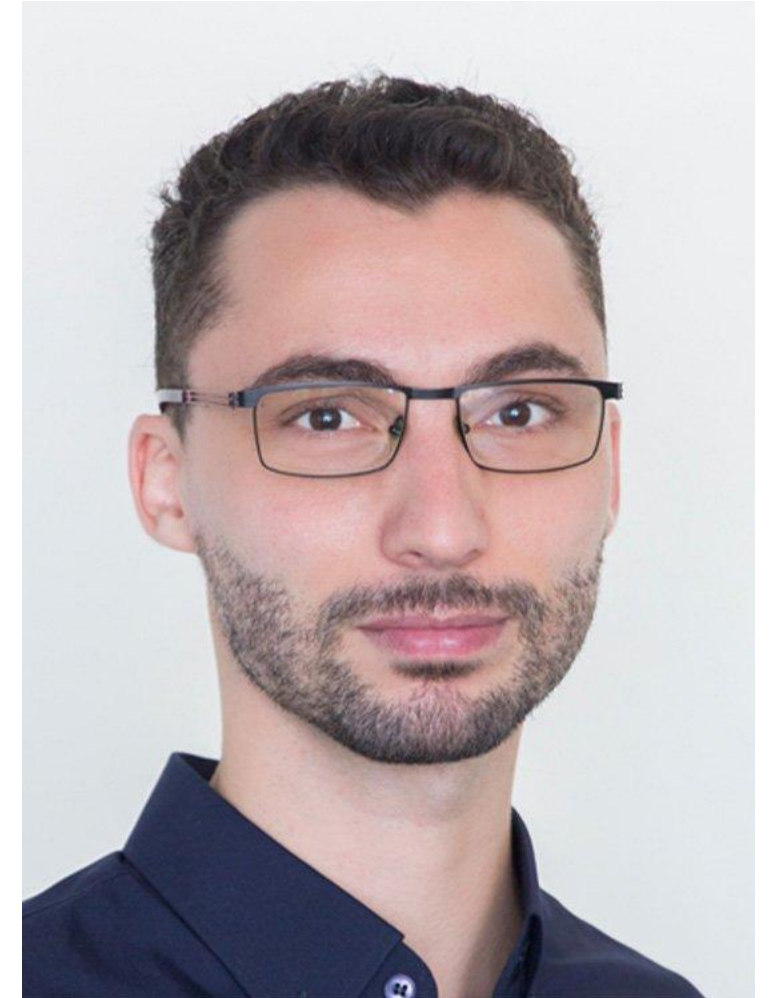


SINGAPORE UNIVERSITY OF  
TECHNOLOGY AND DESIGN

# A quick word about instructors

## Matthieu (Matt) De Mari

- Senior Lecturer at SUTD (Python, Deep Learning, Prog. Language Concepts, Capstone, etc.)
- Director of the Master of Science in Design and Artificial Intelligence for Enterprise (MSc DAI-E)
- PhD from CentraleSupélec (France)
- Email: [matthieu\\_demari@sutd.edu.sg](mailto:matthieu_demari@sutd.edu.sg)
- Office @ SUTD: 2.401-07 (located in SUTD Academy/AI cluster).



# A quick word about instructors

## Dileepa Fernando

- Lecturer at SUTD (Python, Software Engineering, Programming Language Concepts and more)
- Computer Science and Design (CSD)
- PhD from NUS
- Email: [dileepa\\_fernando@sutd.edu.sg](mailto:dileepa_fernando@sutd.edu.sg)
- Office @ SUTD: 1.402.24



# A quick word about instructors

## Li Kunrong (TA)

- PhD student under the ISTD pillar.
- Research interests include distributed systems, recommender systems, and LLM, with a focus on applying these techniques in real-world production environments.
- Email: [kunrong\\_li@mymail.sutd.edu.sg](mailto:kunrong_li@mymail.sutd.edu.sg)
- Although currently overseas, our TA will be helping with designing and grading homeworks through the term. You may approach her via email in case of questions about homeworks.

# Objectives of 50.039 DL

- Introduce the technical aspects related to the **implementation of Deep Neural Networks from scratch**.
- Teach the students about the **most popular framework** for implementing Deep Neural Networks (as of Jan 2026): **PyTorch**.
- Discuss the **mathematical foundations and intuitions** behind Deep Learning tools, layers and techniques.
- Give the students a **global overview of the foundational and advanced techniques** related to Deep Learning and Neural Networks.
- Describe **examples of practical applications** of Deep Learning, showing how some key AI tools are implemented.

# Objectives of 50.039 DL

- Eventually, **assemble all concepts and tricks of the trade** discussed in this course to produce big architecture models that are close to the current state-of-the-art ones (e.g. ChatGPT, Dall-E, etc.).
- Discuss **ethical aspects** related to some of the concepts discussed.
- Give students **an understanding of the current state of research in the Deep Learning community**, and more specifically **pointers** on how to stay up-to-date in this fast-evolving field.
- This includes **tracking big names** in the field, identifying **key scientific papers** that have changed the field, but also **newsletters, websites or magazines** that disclose information in Layman terms.

# Skills needed for this course

- **Must-have CS:** Python (loops and OOP!), Numpy, Matplotlib.
- **Must-have Math:** Linear Algebra, Multiple Variables Calculus, Differentiation/Derivatives, Optimization, Probability and Statistics.
- **Good-to-have CS:** ML, Data Processing, Pandas, Scipy, Sklearn.
- **Good-to-have Math:** Graph Theory, Game theory.

**Need to revise? No homeworks for the first couple of weeks...!**

Use this time to revise your 10.014 CTD, 10.013 M&A, 10.018 MS&S,  
10.022 MU, 10.020 DDW, and 50.007 ML!  
(Look at bonus slides for details on what to revise...)

# The way we teach things

## An expert is not someone who

- Took a 6h-long online video course,
- Implements Neural Networks by randomly connecting basic layers (typically Linear and Conv),
- Uses a DL framework they do not understand (or worse, autoML!),
- Cannot obtain more than 95% accuracy on a simple dataset like MNIST or CIFAR-10.

## An expert is someone who

- Understands how Neural Networks operate and the mathematical intuition behind typical/advanced operations used in layers,
- Understands how the frameworks have been built and what they do behind the scenes,
- Understands that AI is a fast-evolving field and knows how to stay up to date when it comes to AI.



# The way we teach things

**One topic per week** (or so) and hopefully, we will cover all the important concepts and important directions of DL these days.

- **Lectures slides**, along with **supporting notebooks**.
- **Mathematical aspects** discussed in class (to show what is happening behind the scenes of Neural Networks/Deep Learning code).
- **Made a choice:** providing lots of code to demonstrate concepts but **need you to play with them autonomously!**
- **Extra reading**, for curiosity (supporting papers, articles, etc.) and suggestions of pointers to stay up-to-date.
- Suggestions for **continuing your learning**, after this course.

# The way we teach things

Every week, I will upload materials on both **eDimension**

- **eDimension lecture materials:** Read-only, reference slides, and supporting Jupyter notebooks.
- **Video recaps (from previous years, being revised as time allows).**

**Note:** The videos can be used for revision and self-study, but they clearly do not mean you should not come to class!

**Attendance will be a key component for the participation score.**

# Syllabus (Detailed syllabus on eDimension)

- **Week 1:** Introduction to course and some ML reminders, including linear and polynomial regression, generalization, ridge regression and regularization, overfitting/underfitting, logistic regression, neurons objects and how they relate to biology. Building our first shallow neural network in Numpy, with gradient descent, training and testing.
- **Week 2:** Introduction to PyTorch framework, tensors and dataloaders. Implementing a shallow neural network in PyTorch, using backpropagation in PyTorch with AutoGrad, advanced optimizers. Multi-label classification with shallow neural networks, moving from shallow to deep neural networks.

# Syllabus

- **Week 3:** Guided project and good practices for Deep Learning projects (train/test/dev, bias/variance, advanced regularization, dropout, normalizing inputs/outputs/layers, trainer functions, savers/loader functions for reproducibility and transfer learning). Discussion about the project assessment component.
- **Week 4:** The image data type, image processing techniques and typical computer vision operations, the convolution operation and layers, Convolutional Neural Networks, advanced CNNs, foundational vision models and transfer learning. Preparing transition to the 50.035 Computer Vision course.

# Syllabus

- **Week 5:** Continuation of Week 4, and more advanced concepts of Computer Vision. Adversarial machine learning, attacking a Neural Network with basic gradient-based attacks, fundamental limits of Neural Networks, defence mechanisms and state-of-the-art of some advanced attacks techniques.
- **Week 6:** Introduction to sequential data (numerical series, times series, etc.), vanilla Recurrent Neural Networks, Gated Recurrent Units, Long-Short Term Memory cells, advanced RNN networks, mixing models for advanced architectures. Recap before MidTerm.

# Syllabus

- **Week 8:** The embedding problem, more advanced concepts on RNNs, introduction to Natural Language Processing (NLP) and Word Embeddings for NLP, brief state-of-the-art on NLP, attention and transformers architectures. Preparing transition to the 50.040 Natural Language Processing course. MidTerm exam (based on W1-6). One lecture might move to Week 6 to make space for MidTerm exam.
- **Week 9:** Introduction to Vision Transformers and how it relates to concepts in W4 and W8. Quick introduction to Graph Theory, typical graph datasets and problems, basics of Graph Convolutional Networks, brief state-of-the-art of advanced GCNs.

# Syllabus

- **Week 10:** Generative Models, Autoencoders and Variational Autoencoders, Generative Adversarial Networks (GANs), Advanced concepts on Generative Adversarial Networks, why is it so difficult to train GANs in practice. If time allows, practice on GANs.
- **Week 11:** Brief introduction to reinforcement learning, and state-action-rewards systems, multi-armed bandit problem and the exploration/exploitation trade-off, Q-learning and Deep Q-Learning. Reinforcement Learning with Human Feedback. Brief state-of-the-art discussion about further works in Reinforcement Learning.

# Syllabus

- **Week 12:** Topics for curiosity. Introduction to Physics-Informed Neural Networks. Basic introduction to deep belief and diffusion models (more details to be covered in the 50.035 Computer Vision course). Introduction to Explainability/Interpretability, ethical questions on Deep Learning and open questions in research about Neural Networks.
- **Week 13:** A word about ChatGPT, from a Deep Learning expert point of view. Closing and future directions for studying Deep Learning. Project presentations and possibly some guest conferences (TBA).
- **Week 14:** Final exam (probably on content from W1-12).



# Supporting Textbooks

Supporting textbooks, for your curiosity (not needed to understand this course, just for reference).

- Michael A. Nielsen, “Neural networks and deep learning”, 2015.  
(<http://neuralnetworksanddeeplearning.com/>)
- Ian Goodfellow, Yoshua Bengio and Aaron Courville, “Deep learning”, 2016.  
(<https://www.deeplearningbook.org/>)
- Stevens et al., “Deep Learning with PyTorch”, 2020.  
(<https://www.manning.com/books/deep-learning-with-pytorch>)

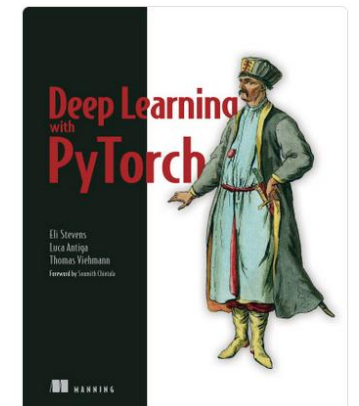
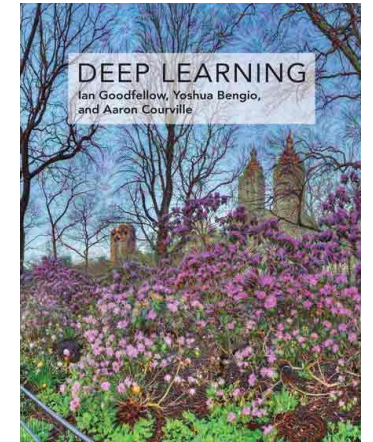
## Neural Networks and Deep Learning

*Neural Networks and Deep Learning* is a free online book. The book will teach you about:

- Neural networks, a beautiful biologically-inspired programming paradigm which enables a computer to learn from observational data
- Deep learning, a powerful set of techniques for learning in neural networks

Neural networks and deep learning currently provide the best solutions to many problems in image recognition, speech recognition, and natural language processing. This book will teach you many of the core concepts behind neural networks and deep learning.

For more details about the approach taken in the book, [see here](#). Or you can jump directly to [Chapter 1](#) and get started.



# Evaluation and grading

- **Homeworks (15%):** Given on Weeks 3, 5, 8, 10 (tentative)  
Usually come in the form of a Jupyter Notebook, containing explanations, code snippets and questions.  
Submissions on eDimension, two weeks later or so, as a small PDF report containing code, figures and answers to questions.  
When time allows, debrief of homeworks in class.
- **MidTerm Exam (25%):** Usually given on Week 6, to be confirmed.  
Theoretical, paper exam, notions of Week 1-6 to be tested.  
More details about venue and exam to be announced closer to the exam date.

# Evaluation and grading

- **Final Exam (25%):** Given on Week 14, date to be confirmed. Theoretical, paper exam, notions of Week 1-13 to be tested. More details about venue and exam to be announced.
- **Project (28%):** Groups of 2-3 students. Submission for project (code, report, presentation) expected on Week 13. More details about the project will be given on Week 3.
- **Participation (5%):** To our discretion.
- **Student Feedback Survey (2%):** As per usual.

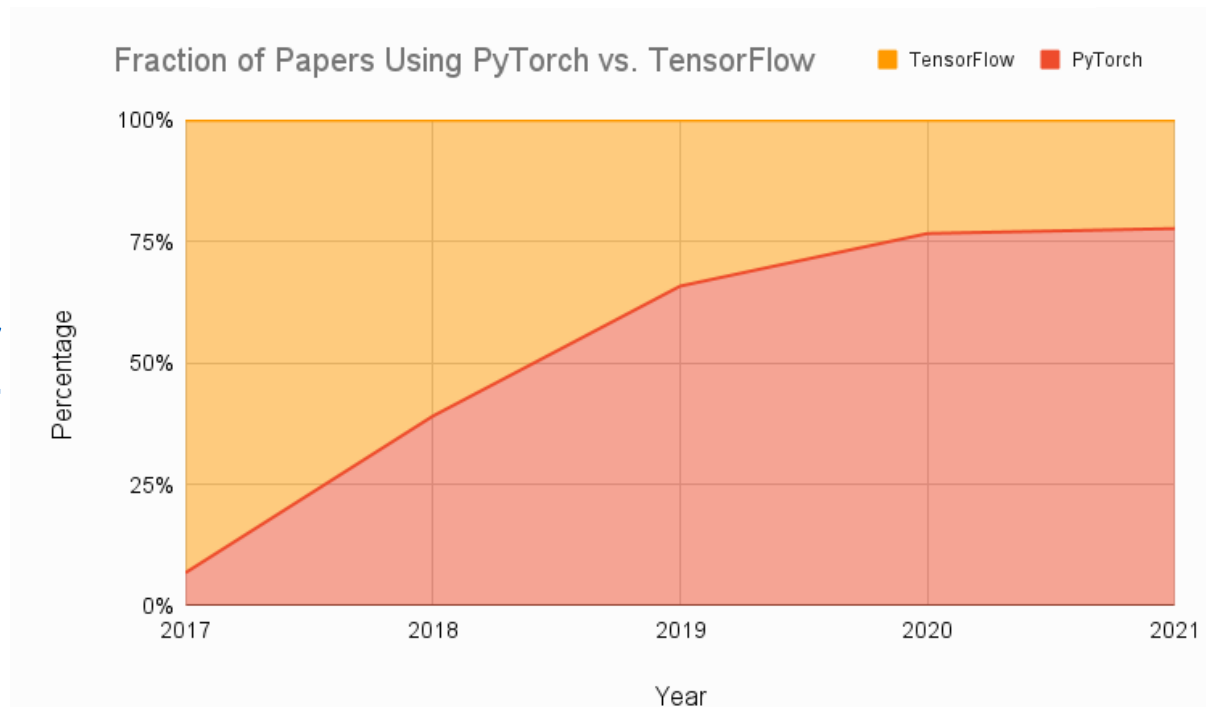
# Technical pre-requisites

- Install **Python 3**, if you have not done so already (this course does not use the C++/Java version of PyTorch).
- **Libraries needed:** numpy, matplotlib, scipy, sklearn, networkx, pillow, gym, torch, torchvision, torchmetrics, etc.
- **Jupyter notebooks** for demos of code, along with the slides.
- In doubt, you can always use **Google Colab** to run the codes.



# Technical pre-requisites

- Framework of choice will be **PyTorch!** (not Tensorflow, not Keras, not MXNet, etc.)
- Increasing popularity and preferred to Google's Tensorflow these days for many reasons.
- Learn more, if curious:  
<https://www.assemblyai.com/blog/pytorch-vs-tensorflow-in-2022/>
- Also, this:  
<https://arxiv.org/abs/2508.04035>



# Installing PyTorch and CUDA

- Install PyTorch, by getting the latest version (not the one shown below!) from <https://pytorch.org/get-started/locally/>
- Setting up CUDA/GPU acceleration is always a good idea! (More details in bonus slides).

|                   |                                                                                                         |           |                   |        |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------------|--------|
| PyTorch Build     | Stable (2.0.1)                                                                                          |           | Preview (Nightly) |        |
| Your OS           | Linux                                                                                                   | Mac       | Windows           |        |
| Package           | Conda                                                                                                   | Pip       | LibTorch          | Source |
| Language          | Python                                                                                                  |           | C++ / Java        |        |
| Compute Platform  | CUDA 11.7                                                                                               | CUDA 11.8 | ROCm 5.4.2        | CPU    |
| Run this Command: | <pre>pip3 install torch torchvision torchaudio --index-url https://download.pytorch.org/whl/cu117</pre> |           |                   |        |

# 50.039 Theory and Practice of Deep Learning

## W1-S1 Introduction and Machine Learning Reminders

Matthieu De Mari



# About this week (Week 1)

1. What are the **typical concepts of Machine Learning** to be used as a starting point for this course?
2. What are the **different families of problems** in Deep Learning?
3. What is the **typical structure of a Deep Learning problem**?
4. What is **linear regression** and how to implement it?
5. What is the **gradient descent algorithm** and how is it used to **train Machine Learning models**?
6. What is **polynomial regression** and how to implement it?
7. What is **regularization** and how to implement it in **Ridge regression**?



# About this week (Week 1)

8. What is **overfitting** and why is it bad?
9. What is **underfitting** and why is it bad?
10. What is **generalization** and how to evaluate it?
11. What is a **train-test split** and why is it related to **generalization**?
12. What is a **sigmoid** function? What is a **logistic** function?
13. How to perform **binary classification** using a **logistic regressor** and how is it related to linear regression?

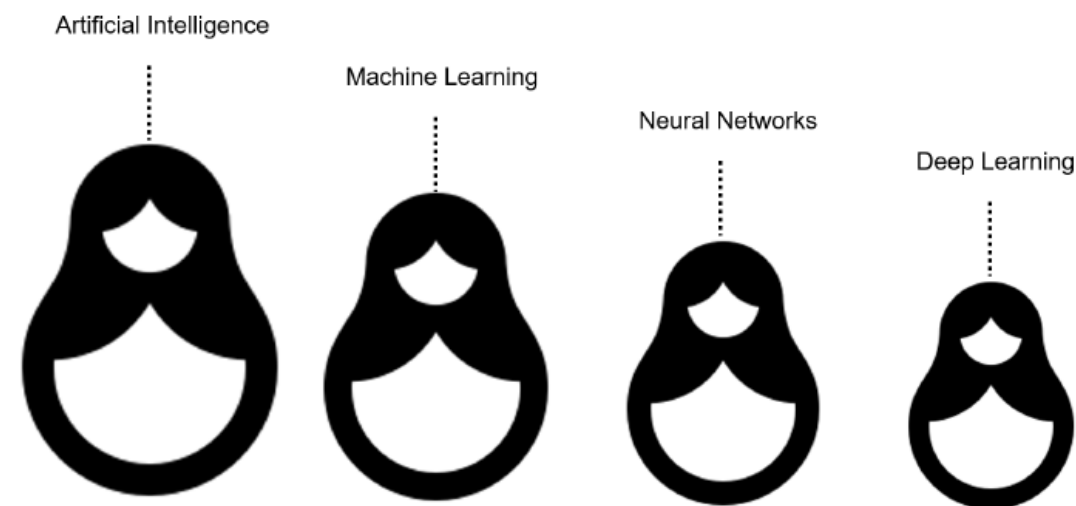
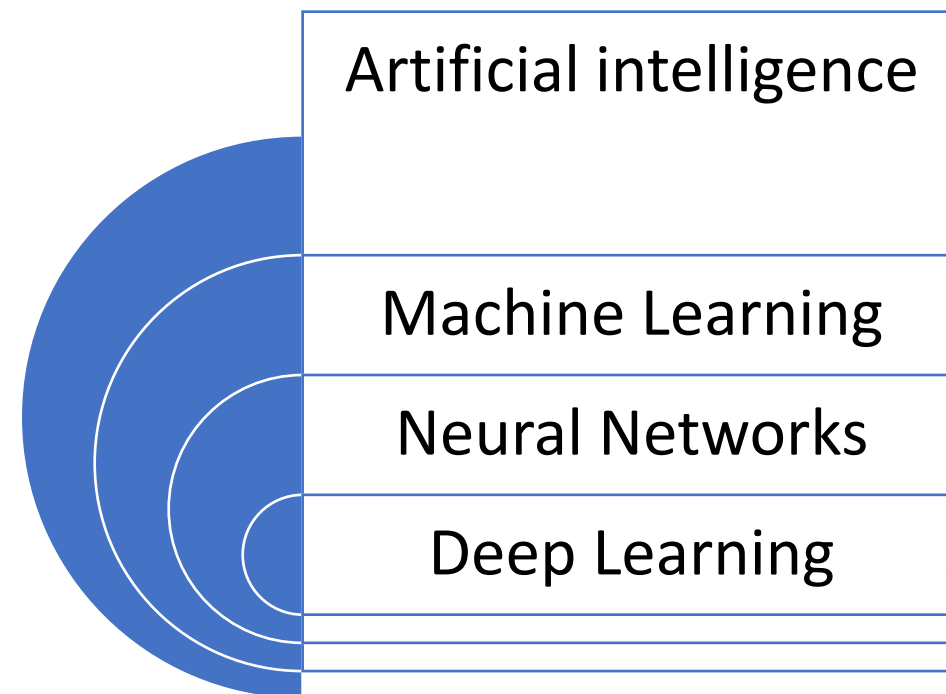
# About this week (Week 1)

14. What are **Neural Networks** and how do they relate to the **biology of a human brain**?
15. What is a **Neuron** in a Neural Network and how does it relate to linear/logistic regression?
16. What is the **difference** between a **shallow** and a **deep neural network**?
17. How to **implement a shallow Neural Network** manually and define a **forward propagation** method for it?
18. How to **train a shallow Neural Network** using **backpropagation**?  
How to define **backward propagation** and **trainer** functions?

# What is AI/ML/NN/DL?

## Definition (**Artificial Intelligence**):

In Computer Science, **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** refers to the theory and development of computer systems capable to **replicate/emulate the human brain**, more specifically **perform cognitive tasks** that normally require human intelligence, such as visual perception, speech recognition, decision-making, and translation between languages.



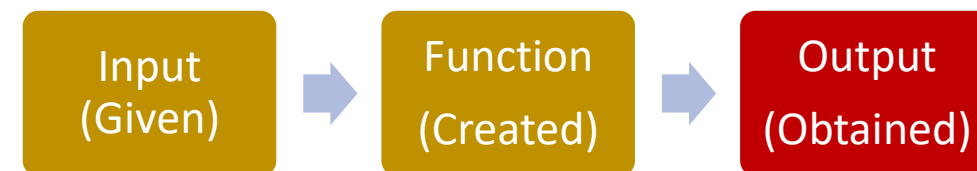
# What is AI/ML/NN/DL?

## Definition (**Machine Learning**):

In Computer Science, **Machine Learning (ML)** refers to the field of study that describes **techniques** and **algorithms** that give computers the **ability to learn without being explicitly programmed**.

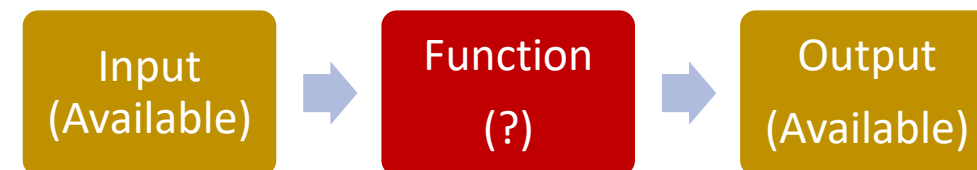
Some implementations of machine learning may rely on **data** and **neural networks**.

### Conventional programming



VS.

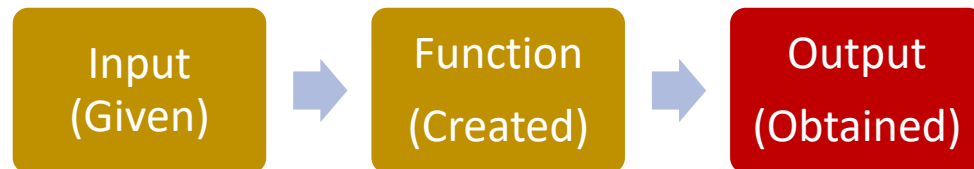
### Machine Learning



# What is AI/ML/NN/DL?

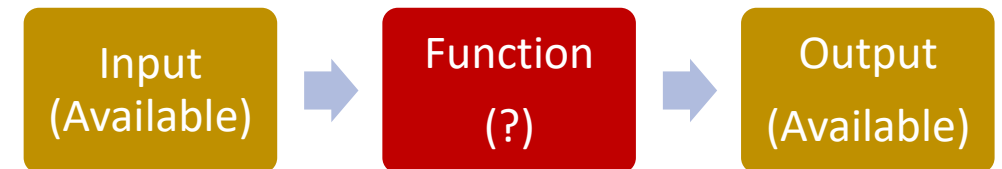
What we have done in programming so far was to design functions,

- which would do **specific operations**,
- and return **outputs**,
- for any **input** we could give it.



But sometimes, we can encounter problems where

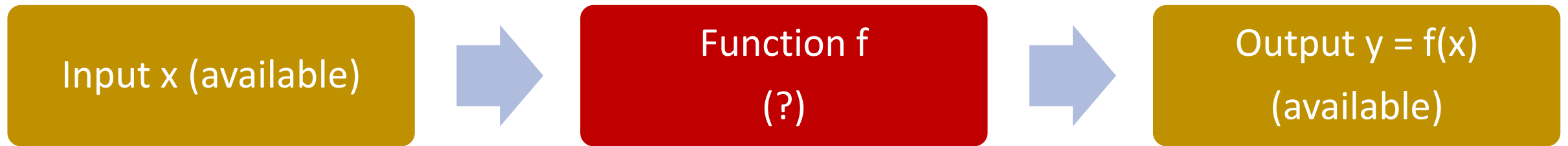
- we can easily find **inputs** and **expected** outputs,
- but the **function** to be coded is **not simple** to figure out.
- **E.g., what animal in picture?**



# What is AI/ML/NN/DL?

E.g., what animal is in the picture?

Typical problem in **Computer Vision**, called **Image Recognition**.



Very easy for a human...  
**But, how would we explain the  
logic of it to a computer?**

It's a cat!

# What is AI/ML/NN/DL?

Other scenarios have to do with tasks where there is **no easy closed-form expression connecting inputs to outputs.**

- E.g., what is a good selling price for my apartment?
- How would you guess the selling price of an apartment based on its parameters (size, location, etc.) and previous sales?

**S\$1,680,000**

Negotiable

3  3  1184 sqft S\$ 1,418.92 psf

## Details

|                                |                  |
|--------------------------------|------------------|
| Property Type                  | Floor Size       |
| Executive Condominium For Sale | 1184 sqft        |
| Developer                      | PSF              |
| Tampines EC Pte Ltd            | S\$ 1,418.92 psf |
| Furnishing                     | Floor Level      |
| Partially Furnished            | High Floor       |
| Tenure                         | TOP              |
| 99-year Leasehold              | January, 2016    |



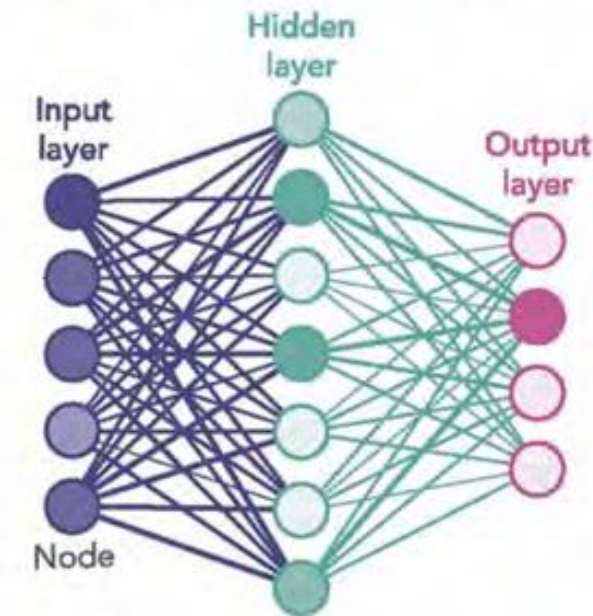
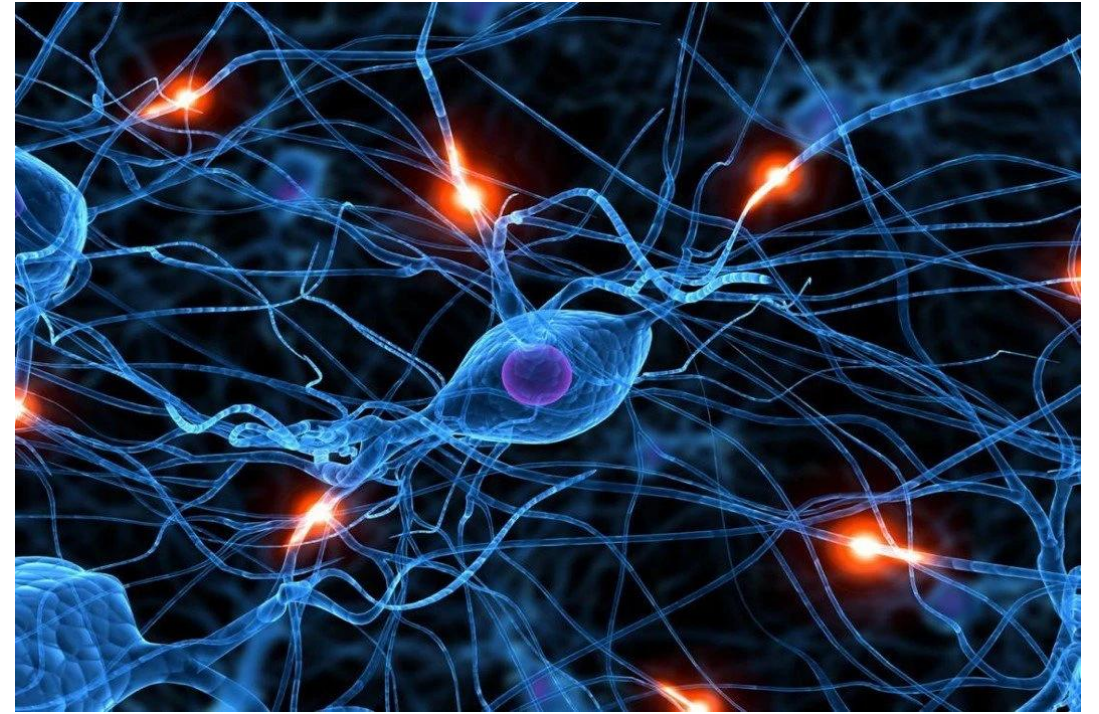


# What is AI/ML/NN/DL?

## Definition (**Neural Networks**):

**Neural Networks (NNs)** are computing systems inspired by the biological neural networks that constitute animal brains.

NNs are based on a **collection of connected units (or nodes) called artificial neurons**, which are a (loose) model for the neurons in a biological brain.





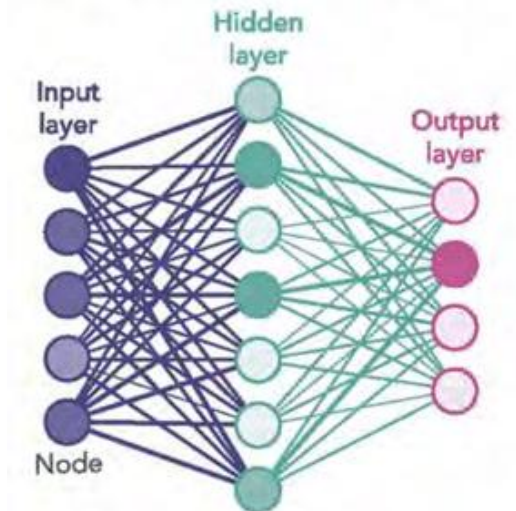
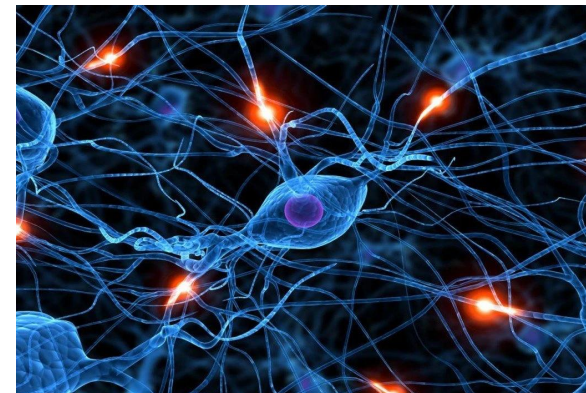
# What is AI/ML/NN/DL?

## Definition (**Neural Networks**):

**Neural Networks (NNs)** are computing systems inspired by the biological neural networks that constitute animal brains.

NNs are based on a **collection of connected units (or nodes)** called **artificial neurons**, which are a (loose) model for the neurons in a biological brain.

Each connection, like the synapses in a biological brain, can transmit a signal to other neurons, therefore **processing any information given as inputs and producing a final signal as output.**

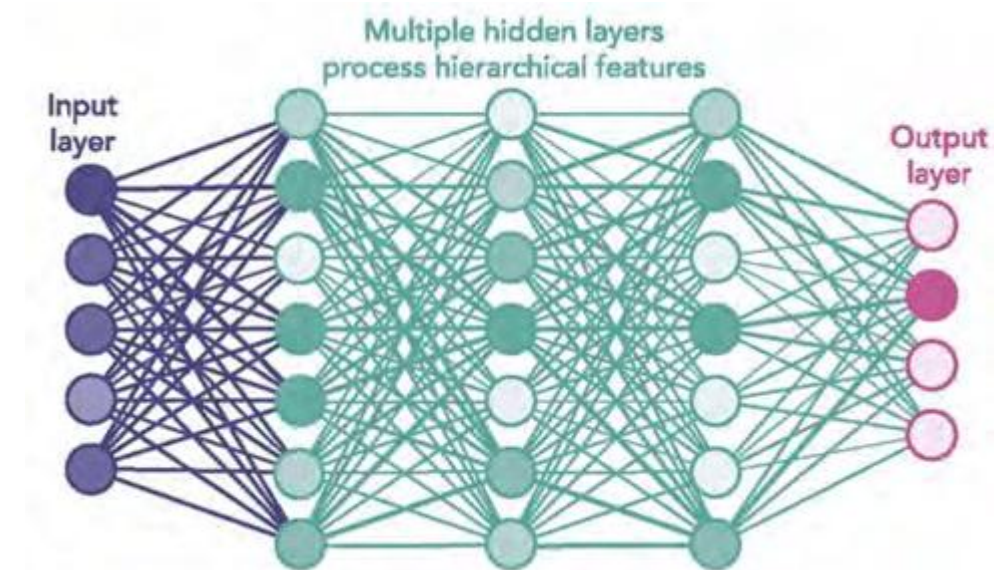
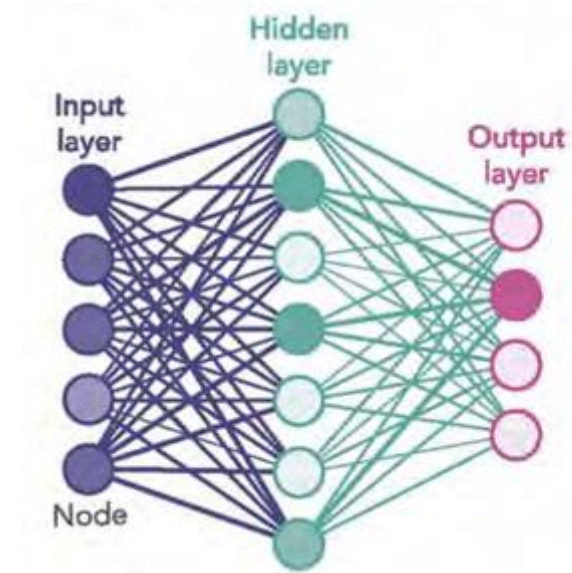


# What is AI/ML/NN/DL?

## Definition (**Deep Learning**):

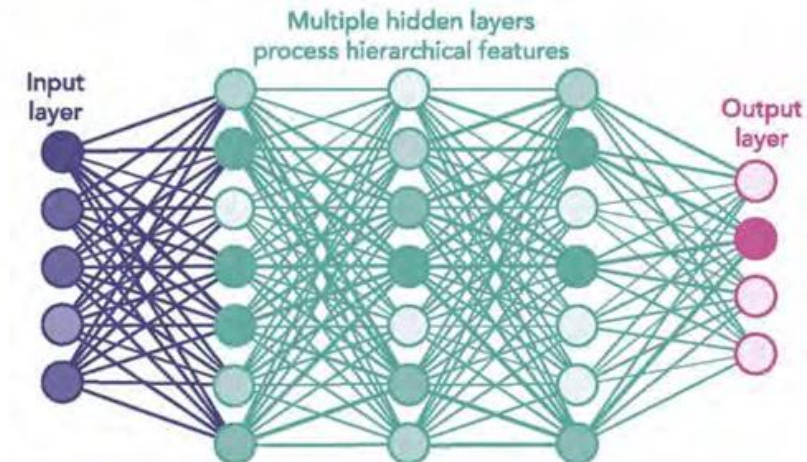
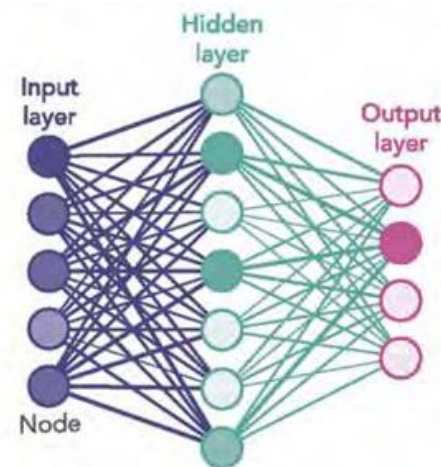
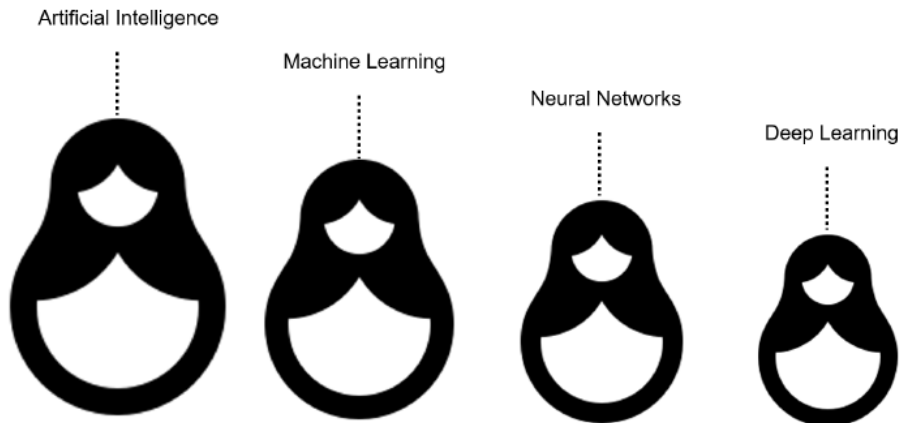
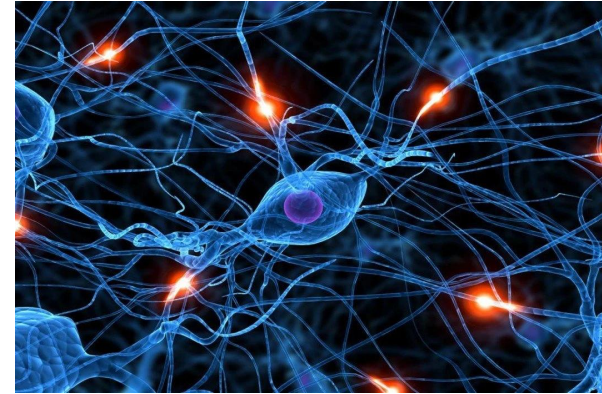
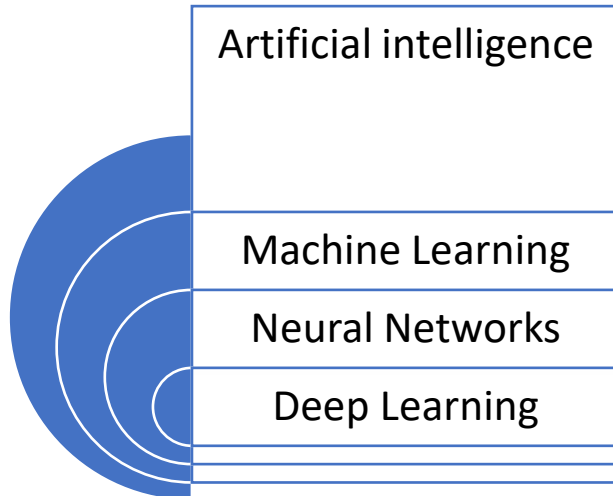
**Deep Learning (DL)** is a subfield of machine learning, and **deep neural networks** make up the backbone of deep learning algorithms.

The **number of node layers**, or **depth**, of neural networks is what distinguishes a **shallow neural network** from a **deep neural network**, which must have more than three.





# What is AI/ML/NN/DL?



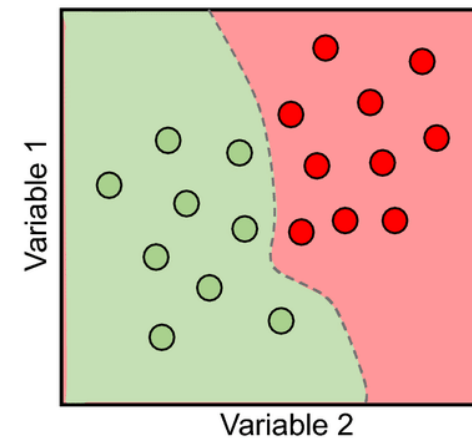
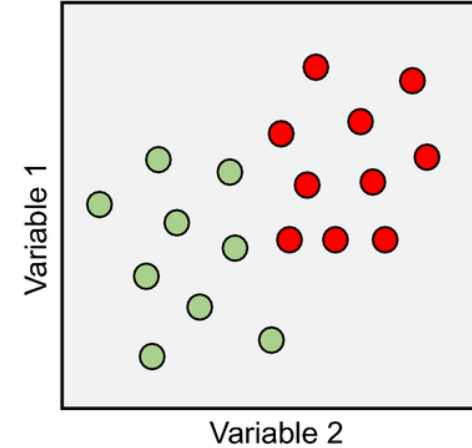
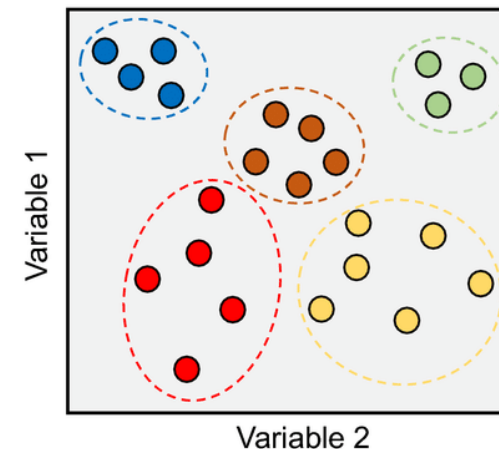
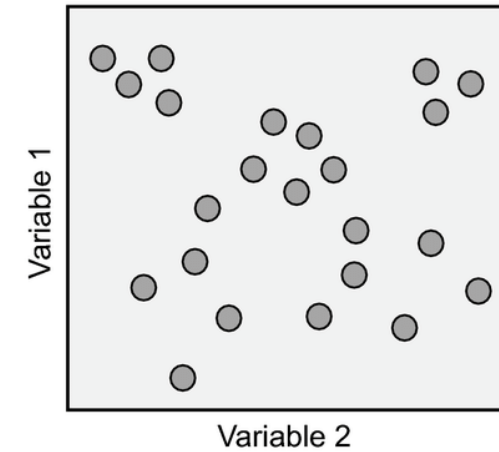
# Supervised vs Unsupervised Learning

## Definition (Supervised vs. Unsupervised Learning):

**Supervised** and **Unsupervised Learning** are the two techniques of ML.

The main difference is **the need for labelled training data**:

- **Supervised machine learning** relies on **labelled input and output data** to learn and make predictions,
- while **unsupervised machine learning** **does not require labelled data**.



# Supervised Learning Examples

- Examples of **supervised learning**: spam detection, text classification, predicting the stock market, etc.

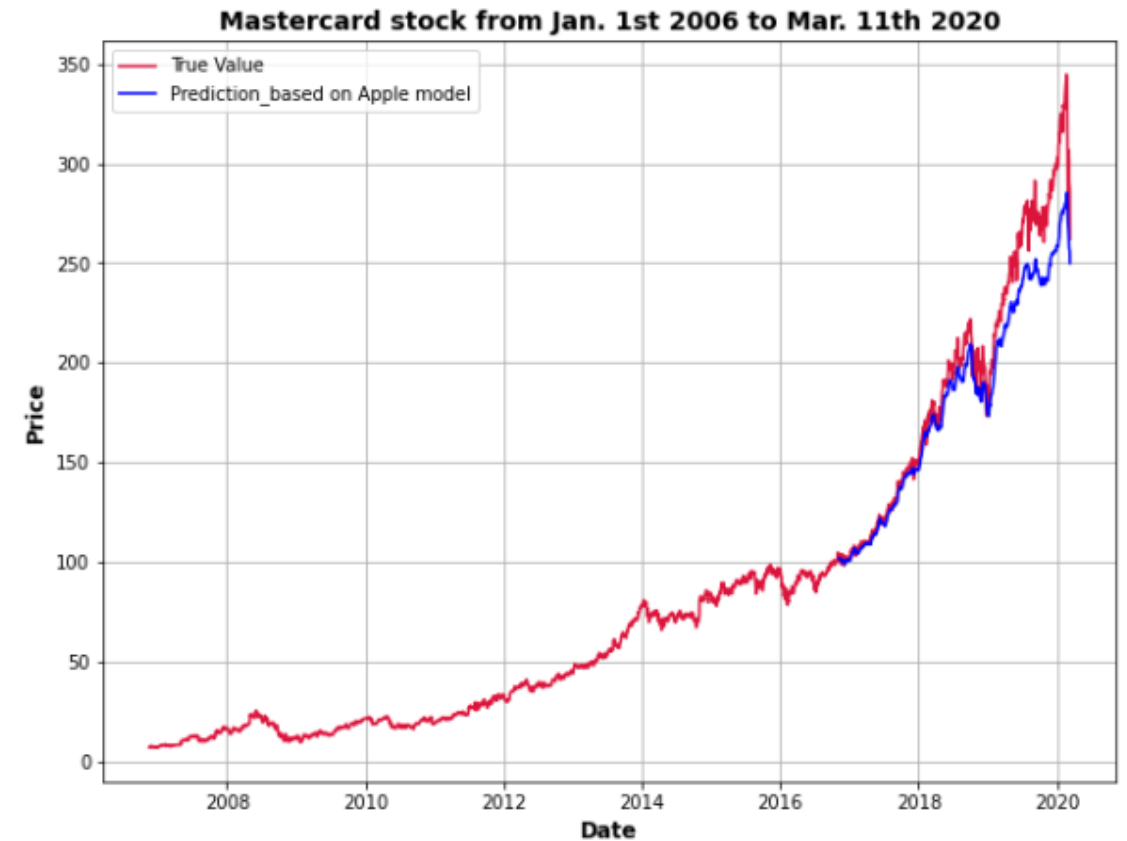
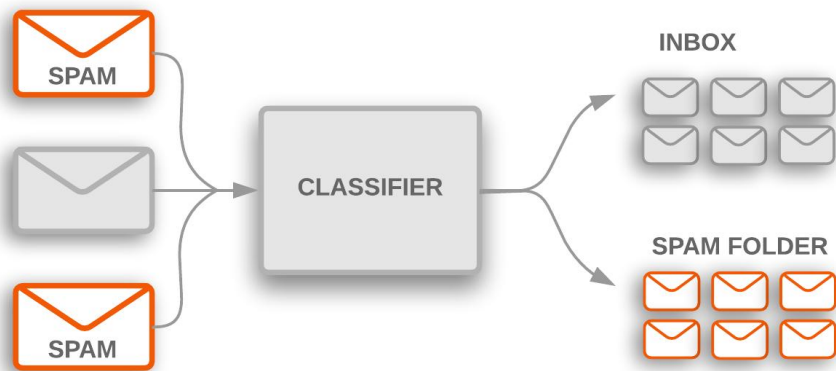


Figure 7. MAST stock price predictions using LSTM trained on AAPL

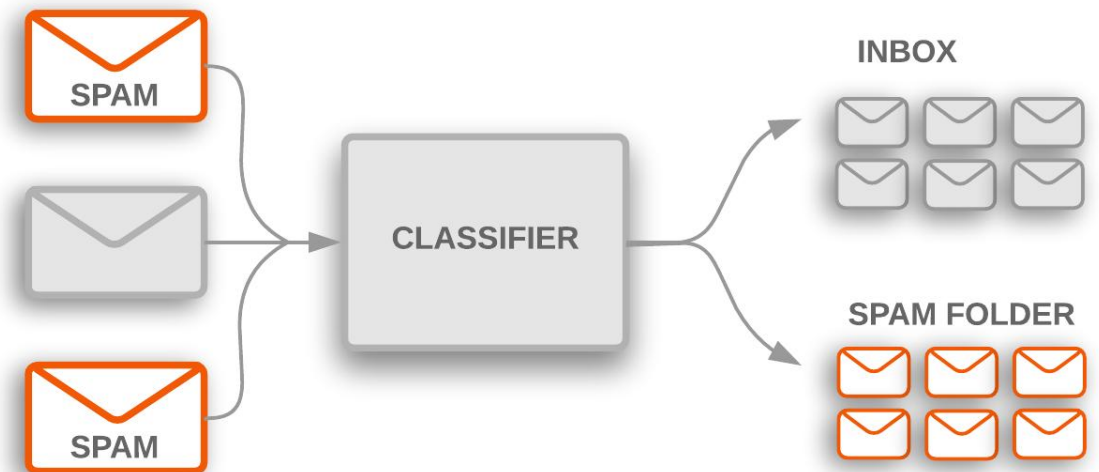
# Regression vs. Classification (Supervised)

## Definition (**Classification**):

Classification models are used to divide the samples in the dataset into different **classes**.

Classification algorithms are then used to predict/classify **discrete or finite number values**, such as Male or Female, True or False, Spam or Not Spam, etc.

In Classification, the outputs are **discrete or categorical values**.



# Regression vs. Classification

## Definition (**Regression**):

Regression models are used to identify the relationships between the input and output variables.

Regression algorithms are used to **predict continuous values** such as price, salary, age, etc.

In regression, the outputs are often **continuous numerical values**.

**S\$1,680,000**

Negotiable

3  3  1184 sqft S\$ 1,418.92 psf

### Details

Property Type

Executive Condominium For Sale

Floor Size

1184 sqft

Developer

Tampines EC Pte Ltd

PSF

S\$ 1,418.92 psf

Furnishing

Partially Furnished

Floor Level

High Floor

Tenure

99-year Leasehold

TOP

January, 2016





# Supervised Learning Examples

**Example:** predicting the market.

**Question:** is it a **regression** or a **classification** task?

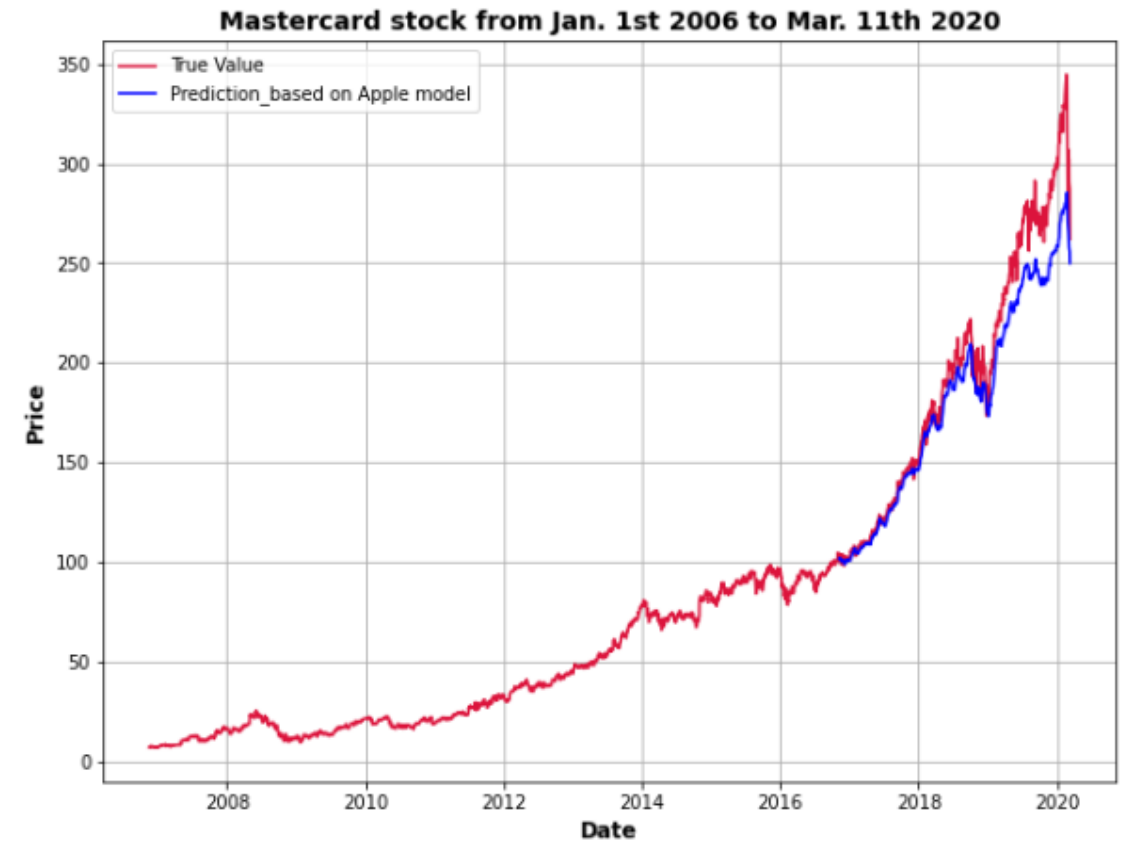


Figure 7. MAST stock price predictions using LSTM trained on AAPL



# Supervised Learning Examples

**Example:** predicting the market.

**Question:** is it a **regression** or a **classification** task?

**Depends.**

If the output we are **predicting** is **the value of the stock in the future**, then probably **regression**.

If the plan is to **predict whether we should buy, sell or hold**, then probably **classification**.

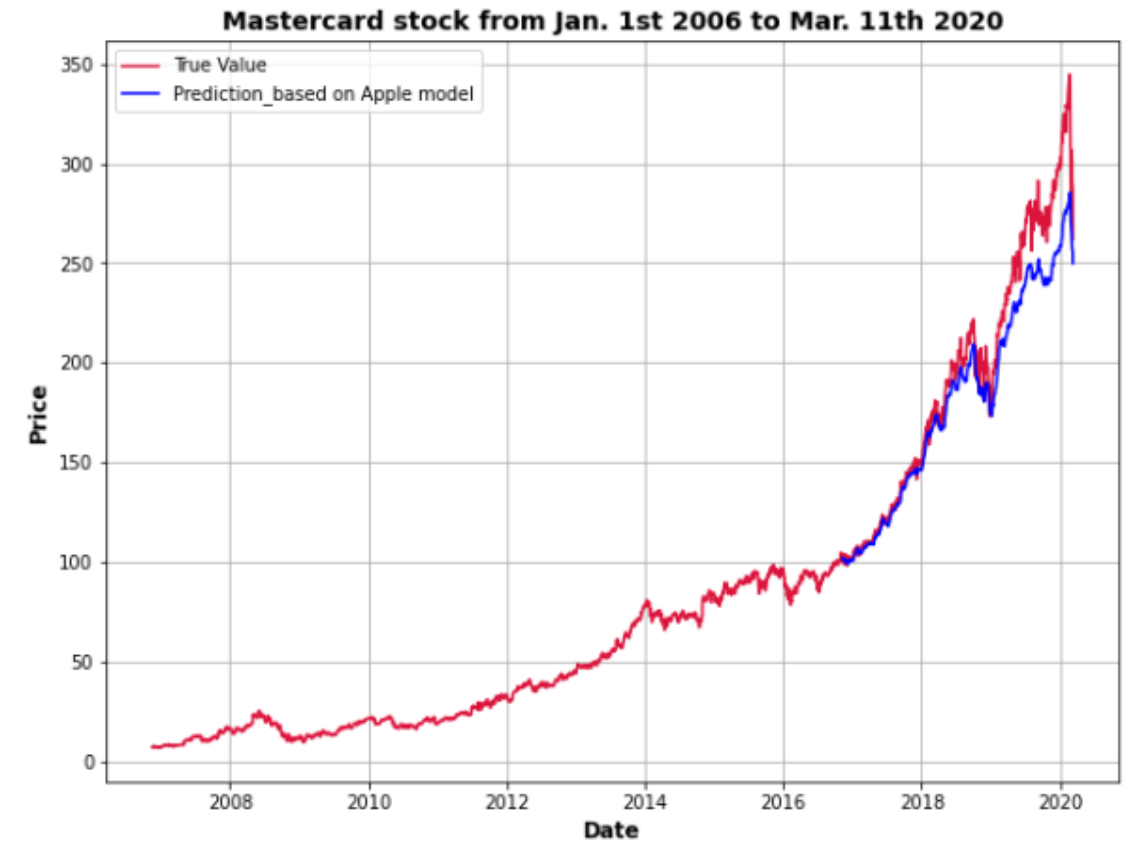


Figure 7. MAST stock price predictions using LSTM trained on AAPL

# Deep Learning and Supervised/Unsupervised

While it is possible to use Deep Learning models and Neural Networks to perform both Supervised and Unsupervised tasks...

The vast majority of DL/NN tasks fall in the category of **supervised learning**.

(And we will therefore mostly focus on that)

# Elements of an ML problem

## Definition (**Elements of a ML problem**):

Machine learning problems should be well-defined, i.e. the following elements must be clearly identified:

1. **Task (T)** at hand,
2. **Inputs (I)** and **Outputs (O)**,
3. **Model (M)** definition and its **trainable parameters (P)**,
4. **Loss (L)** function to measure the performance of current model on said task and dataset.

**s\$1,680,000**

Negotiable

3  3  1184 sqft s\$ 1,418.92 psf

### Details

|                                |                  |
|--------------------------------|------------------|
| Property Type                  | Floor Size       |
| Executive Condominium For Sale | 1184 sqft        |
| Developer                      | PSF              |
| Tampines EC Pte Ltd            | S\$ 1,418.92 psf |
| Furnishing                     | Floor Level      |
| Partially Furnished            | High Floor       |
| Tenure                         | TOP              |
| 99-year Leasehold              | January, 2016    |



# Our first toy example

**Our first toy example:** simplified version of the apartment price prediction.

## 1. Task (T) at hand:

- **Predict price of an apartment based on the apartment features.**
- We will generate a “fake” dataset consisting of apartments with features and selling prices.
- It is a **supervised regression task**.

s\$1,680,000

Negotiable

3  3  1184 sqft s\$ 1,418.92 psf

### Details

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# Our first toy example

**Our first toy example:** simplified version of the apartment price prediction.

## 2. Inputs (I) and Outputs (O):

- **Inputs** will be a **list of apartment features**, which here will only consist of the **surface of the apartment**, in square meters (sqm).
- **Output** will be the **selling price** in millions of SGD (mSGD).

s\$1,680,000

Negotiable

3 🏠 3 🚗 1184 sqft s\$ 1,418.92 psf

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# Our first toy example (mock dataset)

**Have a look at Week 1, Notebook 1.**

We will create a dataset, which uses surfaces as inputs, with values drawn randomly between 40 and 150 sqm.

We will assume that the price is randomly generated, using a uniform distribution, with:

- Average price being  $100000 + 14373$  times the surface in sqm,
- and a random "variation" of  $\pm 10\%$  around the average value.

# Our first toy example (mock dataset)

```
1 # Two random generator functions to generate a mock dataset.
2 # 1. Surfaces randomly generated as uniform between min_surf and max_surf
3 def surface(min_surf, max_surf):
4     return round(np.random.uniform(min_surf, max_surf), 2)
```

```
1 # 2. Price is 100000 + 14373 times the surface in sqm, +/- 10%
2 # (randomly shifted to give the dataset some diversity).
3 def price(surface):
4     # Note: this will return the price in millions of SGD.
5     return round((100000 + 14373*surface)*(1 + np.random.uniform(-0.1, 0.1)))/1000000
```

```
1 # 3. Generate dataset function
2 def generate_datasets(n_points, min_surf, max_surf):
3     x = np.array([surface(min_surf, max_surf) for _ in range(n_points)])
4     y = np.array([price(i) for i in x])
5     return x, y
```

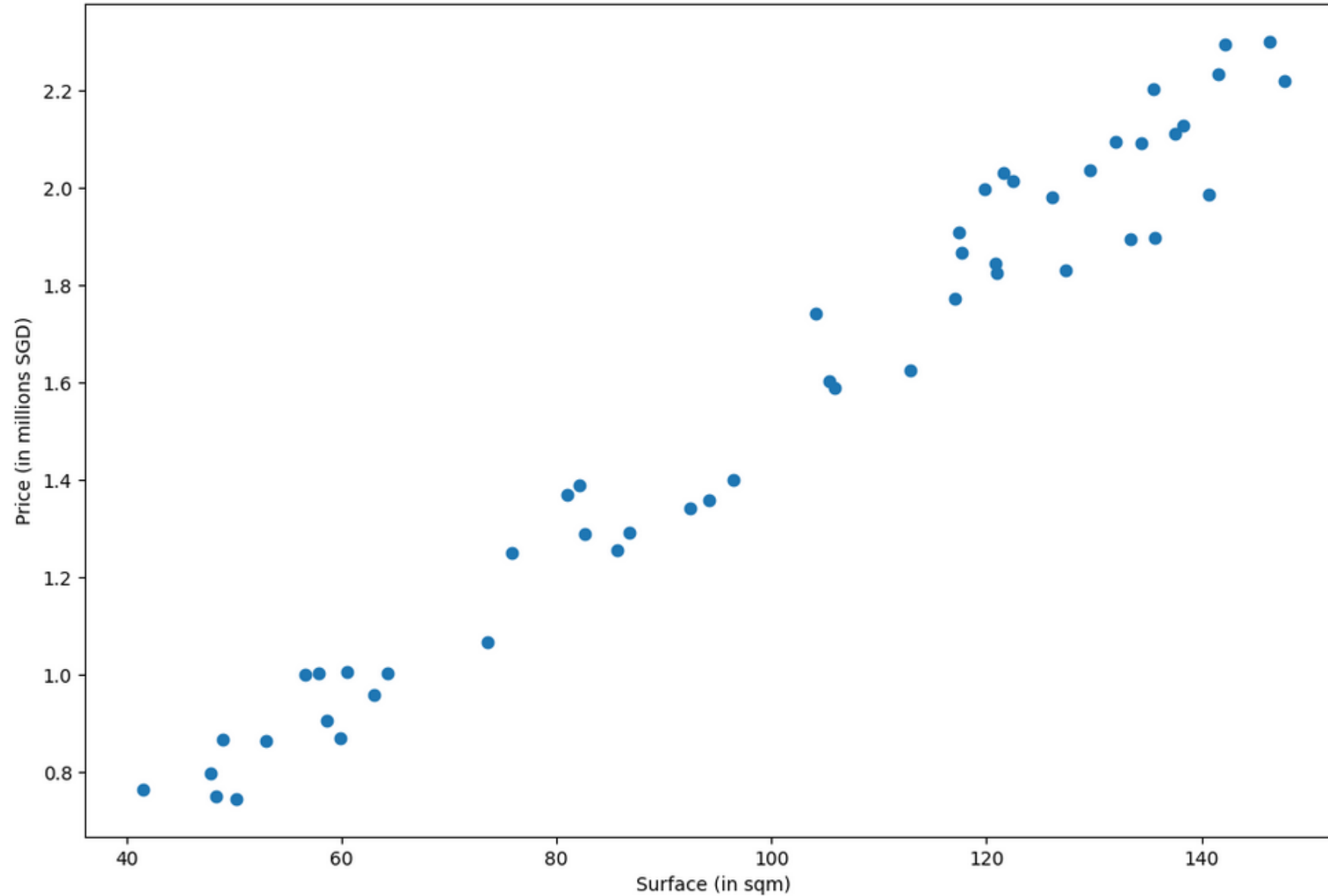


# Our first toy example (mock dataset)

```
1 # 4. Dataset generation (n_points points will be generated).
2 # Surfaces randomly generated as uniform between 40sqm and 150sqm.
3 # We will use a seed for reproducibility.
4 min_surf = 40
5 max_surf = 150
6 np.random.seed(27)
7 n_points = 50
8 inputs, outputs = generate_datasets(n_points, min_surf, max_surf)
9 print(inputs)
10 print(outputs)
```

```
[ 86.83 129.6  120.89 135.48  82.17 147.74 138.25  63.07 121.6  112.95
 137.55 134.38 122.42 135.72  60.54  75.81  81.02 127.31  56.62  58.69
  48.93  73.57 126.16  57.92  47.77 117.12  59.91 105.88  85.68  96.49
  64.27 119.81 133.44 142.18 120.95  92.42  94.22 105.4  48.36  52.92
 146.31 104.17  50.17  41.5  132.06 140.63 117.5  82.57 117.63 141.56]
[1.290893 2.034977 1.84501  2.201767 1.389632 2.218678 2.127228 0.959054
 2.029469 1.623609 2.111638 2.09194  2.012386 1.89553  1.004256 1.250228
 1.368325 1.830127 1.000719 0.906513 0.867629 1.065907 1.979544 1.001403
 0.796199 1.771816 0.867878 1.587176 1.25434  1.40047  1.002361 1.9972
 1.894479 2.293443 1.823577 1.340533 1.358613 1.602167 0.750759 0.863093
 2.30035  1.741468 0.7448  0.763732 2.093772 1.986868 1.90702  1.289541
 1.86578  2.231851]
```

```
1 # Display dataset and see that there is a rather clear linear trend.  
2 plt.figure(figsize = (12, 8))  
3 plt.scatter(inputs, outputs)  
4 plt.xlabel("Surface (in sqm)")  
5 plt.ylabel("Price (in millions SGD)")  
6 plt.show()
```



# Our first toy example

**Our first toy example:** simplified version of the apartment price prediction.

## 3. Model (M) definition and its trainable parameters (P):

- Here, our model will consist of a **linear regression model**.
- By choosing such a model, we are making the assumption that the price of an apartment is a linear function of the surface of said apartment.

s\$1,680,000

Negotiable

3 🏠 3 🚗 1184 sqft s\$ 1,418.92 psf

### Details

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# Our first model, the linear regression

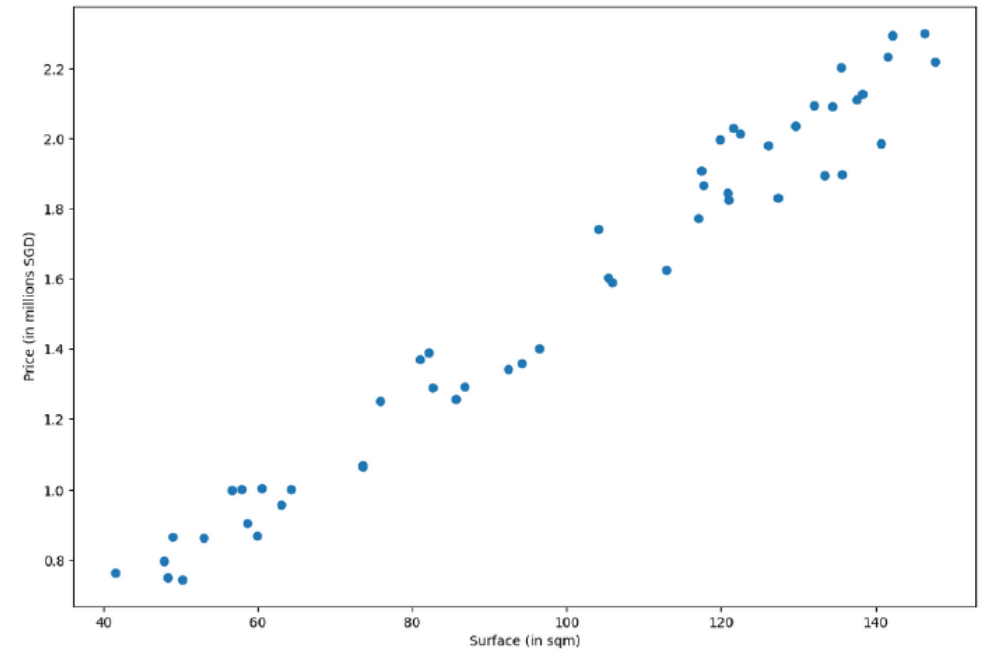
## Definition (Linear Regression):

**Linear Regression** is a model, which **assumes that there is a linear relationship between inputs and outputs.**

It therefore consists of **two trainable parameters** ( $a, b$ ), to be freely chosen.

These will connect any **input**  $x_i$  to its predicted **output**  $y_i$ , with the following equation:

$$y_i \approx a x_i + b$$



```
1 # Linear regression has two trainable parameters (a and b).
2 # Other parameters, like min_surf, max_surf, n_points will
3 # help get points for the upcoming matplotlib displays.
4 def linreg_matplotlib(a, b, min_surf, max_surf, n_points = 50):
5     x = np.linspace(min_surf, max_surf, n_points)
6     y = a*x + b
7     return x, y
```

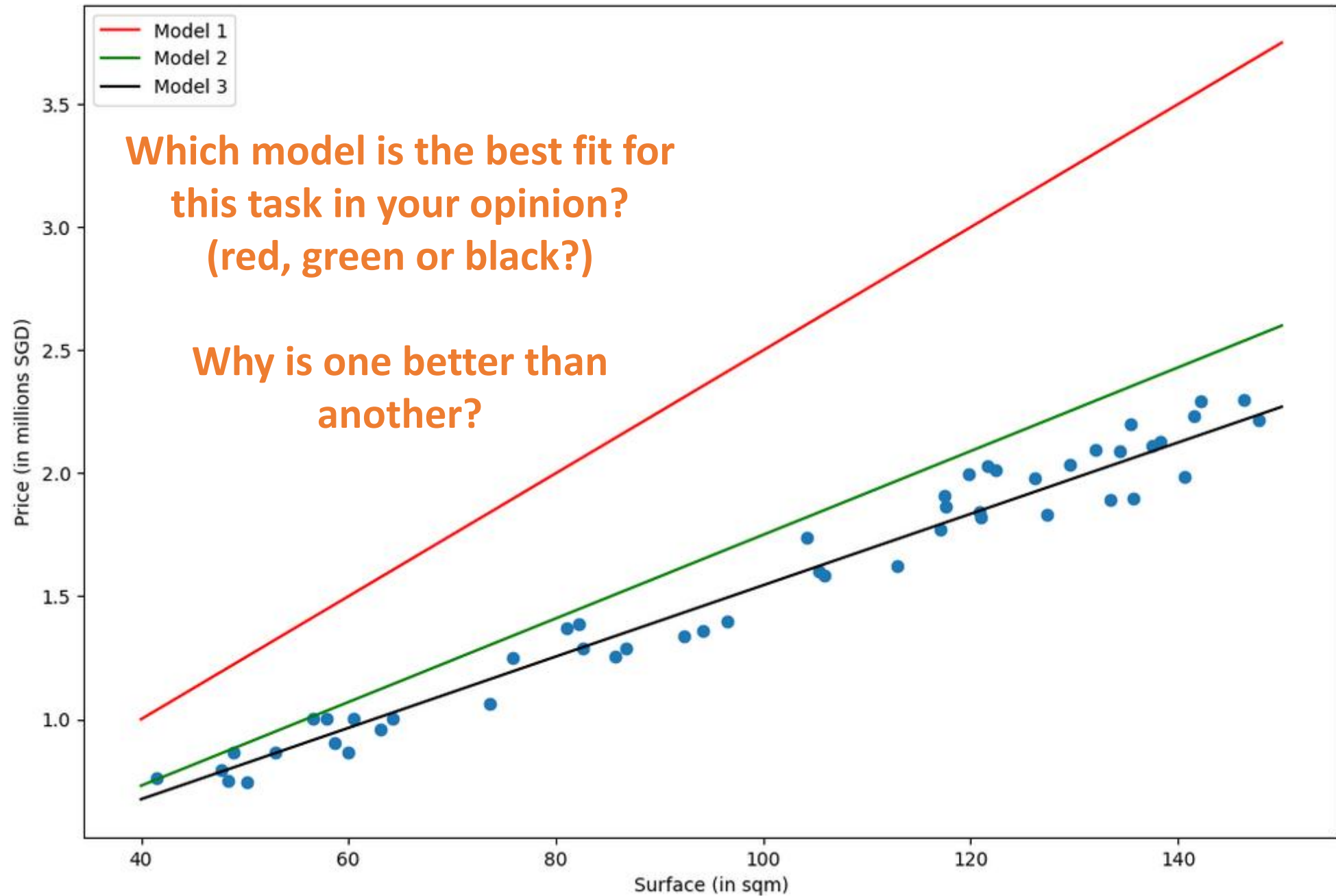
# Let us try different values of (a, b)

Model 1  
(red)

Model 2  
(green)

Model 3  
(black)

```
1 # Display dataset
2 plt.figure(figsize = (12, 8))
3 plt.scatter(inputs, outputs)
4 plt.xlabel("Surface (in sqm)")
5 plt.ylabel("Price (in millions SGD)")
6
7 # Add some Linreg (model 1)
8 a1 = 25000/1000000
9 b1 = 0
10 linreg_dataset1_inputs, linreg_dataset1_outputs = linreg_matplotlib(a1, b1, min_surf, max_surf, n_points)
11 plt.plot(linreg_dataset1_inputs, linreg_dataset1_outputs, 'r', label = "Model 1")
12
13 # Another Linreg (model 2)
14 a2 = 17000/1000000
15 b2 = 50000/1000000
16 linreg_dataset2_inputs, linreg_dataset2_outputs = linreg_matplotlib(a2, b2, min_surf, max_surf, n_points)
17 plt.plot(linreg_dataset2_inputs, linreg_dataset2_outputs, 'g', label = "Model 2")
18
19 # A final Linreg (model 3)
20 a3 = 14500/1000000
21 b3 = 95000/1000000
22 linreg_dataset3_inputs, linreg_dataset3_outputs = linreg_matplotlib(a3, b3, min_surf, max_surf, n_points)
23 plt.plot(linreg_dataset3_inputs, linreg_dataset3_outputs, 'k', label = "Model 3")
24
25 # Display
26 plt.legend(loc = 'best')
27 plt.show()
```



# The need for a loss function

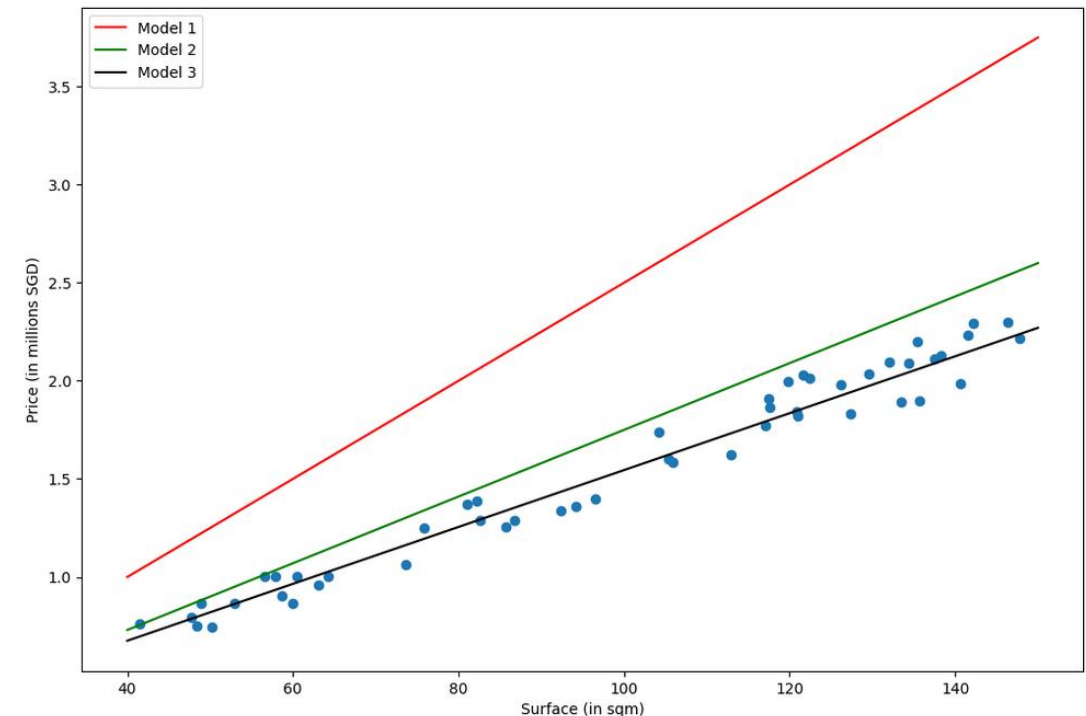
Telling which model is best at a given ML task can prove difficult, especially for close values of its trainable parameters, here  $(a, b)$ .

Good news, there is one last element we have not used yet.

4. **Loss (L)** function to measure the performance of the current model and its current parameters on said task and dataset.

Which model is the best fit for this task in your opinion?  
(red, green or black?)

Why is one better than another?



# The need for a loss function

## Definition (**Loss** function):

A **loss function** (also known as a **cost function**) is a mathematical function that measures the difference between the predicted outputs of a model and the true outputs we should be matching.

It is typically used to:

- **Evaluate the performance of the model,**
- And more specifically **evaluate how good our choice of trainable parameters** (here, the parameters  $a$  and  $b$ ) are at fitting the data.

More importantly, the **loss** function is used to guide the optimization process during **training**.



# The need for a loss function

## Definition (**The Mean Square Error loss function**):

In our linear model, a good loss function we could use consists of the **Mean Square Error (MSE) loss function**.

The MSE is computed by calculating the square difference between:

- The **prediction**  $p_i(x_i, a, b) = ax_i + b$  formed by the model for some given inputs  $x_i$ ,
- The **true value**  $y_i$  that we should be matching.

We then repeat this operation for every sample  $i$ , and average those errors together, i.e.

$$L(a, b, x, y) = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N (p(x_i, a, b) - y_i)^2 = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N (ax_i + b - y_i)^2$$

# The need for a loss function

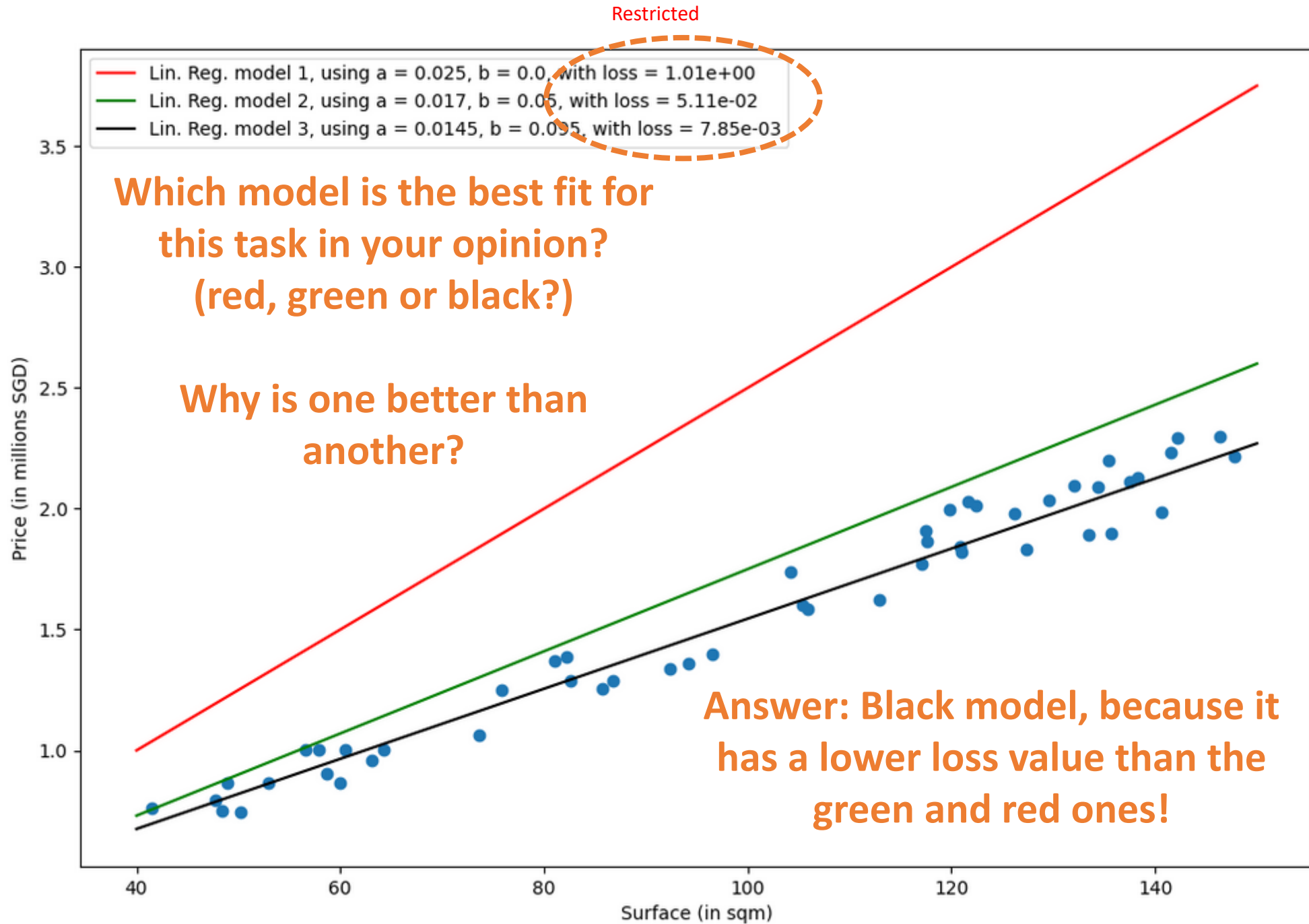
Recall the definition of the MSE loss function

$$L(a, b, x, y) = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N (ax_i + b - y_i)^2$$

```
In [9]: 1 # Mean square error as a loss function
        2 # Displaying loss using exponential notation (XXXe-YYY)
        3 def loss_mse(a, b, x, y):
        4     val = np.sum((y - (a*x + b))**2)/x.shape[0]
        5     return '{:.2e}'.format(val)
```

```
In [10]: 1 # The lower the loss function, the better the linear regression values (a, b) fit the dataset.
        2 loss1 = loss_mse(a1, b1, inputs, outputs)
        3 loss2 = loss_mse(a2, b2, inputs, outputs)
        4 loss3 = loss_mse(a3, b3, inputs, outputs)
        5 print(loss1, loss2, loss3)
```

```
1.01e+00 5.11e-02 7.85e-03
```



# Training a model

## Definition (**Training a model**):

This being said, **we do not just want to choose some good values of the model parameters  $(a, b)$ , we want the best possible values for  $(a, b)$ .**

**Training a model** consists of **finding the best values for the trainable parameters of the chosen model**, for the given task and dataset.

By best values for the trainable parameters, we mean the values that **minimize the chosen loss function**. It is therefore an optimization problem of some sort!

Once a minimal value is obtained on the loss function, then we can claim that the “optimal” trainable parameters have been found. Or in other words, that the model has been **trained**.

# Training a linear regression model

In the case of linear regression, training the model consists of solving the following optimization problem.

$$(a^*, b^*) = \operatorname{argmin}_{a, b} [L(a, b, x, y)]$$

That is, using the explicit formula of the loss function,

$$(a^*, b^*) = \operatorname{argmin}_{a, b} \left[ \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N (ax_i + b - y_i)^2 \right]$$

# Training a linear regression model

## Definition (The **normal equation** for linear regression):

Solving this optimization problem can be done analytically, as it can be proven that the optimal choice of parameters  $W^* = \begin{pmatrix} b^* \\ a^* \end{pmatrix}$  follows the **normal equation**, below.

$$W^* = (X^T X)^{-1} X^T Y$$

*(Proof in bonus slides)*

With

$$X = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & x_1 \\ \dots & \dots \\ 1 & x_N \end{pmatrix}$$

And

$$Y = \begin{pmatrix} y_1 \\ \dots \\ y_N \end{pmatrix}$$

Finally,  $X^T$  denotes the transposed matrix of  $X$  and  $(X)^{-1}$  its inverse.

# Training a linear regression model

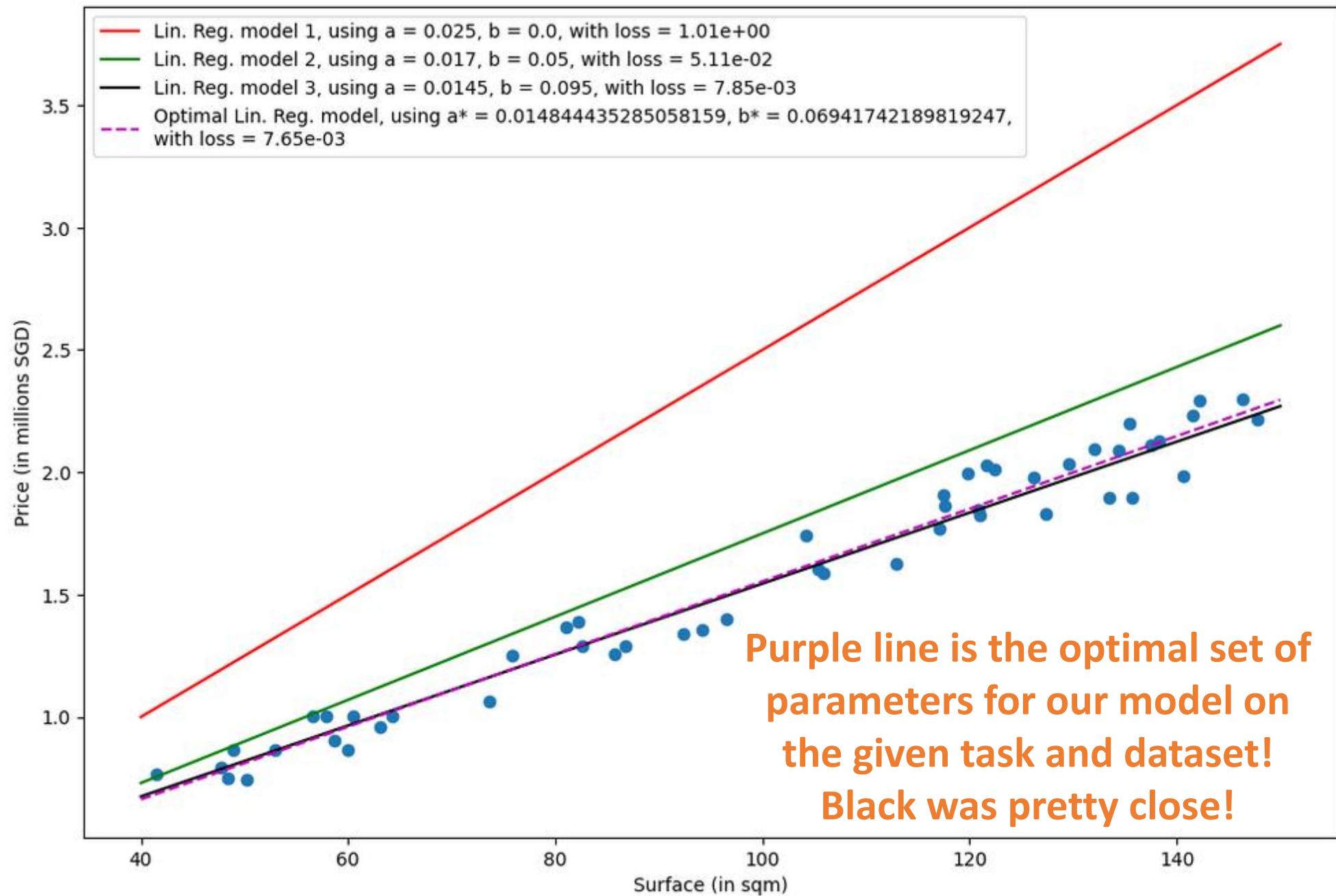
**Normal Equation:**  $W^* = (X^T X)^{-1} X^T Y$

```
1 # Defining the X matrix, following the notation above, as a numpy array.  
2 X = np.array([[1, x_i] for x_i in inputs])  
3 print(X)
```

```
1 # While we are at it, let us define the transposed version of X.  
2 XT = np.transpose(X)  
3 print(XT)
```

```
1 # Defining the Y matrix, following the notation above, as a numpy array.  
2 Y = np.array([y_i for y_i in outputs])  
3 print(Y)
```

```
1 # Defining W_star according to our formula.  
2 W_star = np.matmul(np.linalg.inv(np.matmul(XT,X)), np.matmul(XT,Y))  
3 print(W_star)  
4 # Extracting a_star and b_star values from W_star.  
5 b_star, a_star = W_star[0, 0], W_star[1, 0]  
6 print("Optimal a_star value: ", a_star)  
7 print("The value we used for a in the mock dataset generation: ", 14373/1000000)  
8 print("Optimal b_star value: ", b_star)  
9 print("The value we used for b in the mock dataset generation: ", 100000/1000000)
```





# The problem with the normal equation

The normal equation  $W^* = (X^T X)^{-1} X^T Y$  immediately gives the optimal set of parameters  $(a^*, b^*)$  to use for linear regression.

A few problems when using the normal equation:

- It can become **computationally expensive when the number of samples (or features) in the dataset, and therefore the dimensions in  $X$  are large.**
- In some scenarios, it might even be **impossible to use when the matrix product of feature variables  $(X^T X)^{-1}$  cannot be calculated ( $X^T X$  might not always be invertible).**

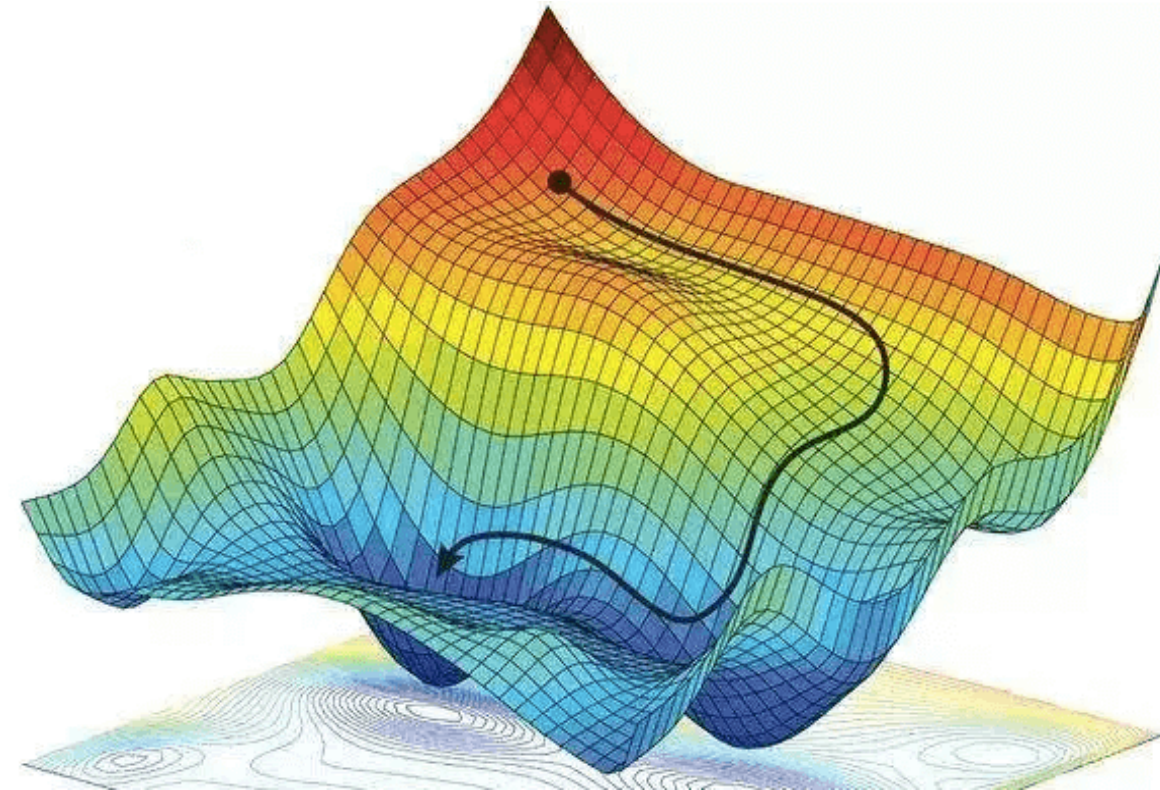
**Another problem: More sophisticated models than linear regression will NOT have a normal equation, anyway.**

# Gradient Descent, to the rescue!

## Definition (**Gradient Descent**):

**Gradient Descent (GD)** is an iterative algorithm used to solve optimization problems.

- It starts with an initial non-optimal set of parameters for our model.
- It then repeatedly updates the parameters in the direction of the negative gradient of the given loss/cost function, until it converges to a local minimum.



*Forgot about GD?  
Have a look at your notes from 10.013 M&A!*

# Gradient Descent, to the rescue!

## Definition (**Gradient Descent**):

**Gradient Descent (GD)** is an iterative algorithm used to solve optimization problems.

- It starts with an initial non-optimal set of parameters for our model.
- It then repeatedly updates the parameters in the direction of the negative gradient of the given loss/cost function, until it converges to a local minimum.
- The normal equation has many problems...
- But GD, on the other hand can be used to find the optimal solution even when the normal equation is not applicable.
- **While sub-optimal, the main advantage of gradient descent is that it can handle very large datasets and it can also be used for non-linear models.**

# GD in Linear Regression

In the case of Linear Regression, with the MSE loss defined earlier, we have

$$(a^*, b^*) = \operatorname{argmin}_{a, b} \left[ L(a, b, x, y) = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N (ax_i + b - y_i)^2 \right]$$

# GD in Linear Regression

We can calculate (by hand) the derivatives, with respect to  $a$  and  $b$ :

$$D_a = \frac{\partial L}{\partial a} = \frac{-2}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N x_i (y_i - (a x_i + b))$$

$$D_b = \frac{\partial L}{\partial b} = \frac{-2}{N} \sum_i y_i - (a x_i + b)$$

# GD in Linear Regression

The gradient descent **update rules** are therefore defined as

$$a \leftarrow a - \alpha D_a$$
$$a \leftarrow a + \frac{2\alpha}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N x_i (y_i - (a x_i + b))$$

And

$$b \leftarrow b - \alpha D_b$$
$$b \leftarrow b + \frac{2\alpha}{N} \sum_i y_i - (a x_i + b)$$

We call parameter  $\alpha$  the **learning rate** for the gradient descent, and this parameter value will have to be decided manually, later.

# GD in Linear Regression

## Gradient Descent Linear Regression procedure:

- We initialize  $a$  and  $b$  with some initial values (could be zero, random values, or something else).
- For a given number of iterations, we will apply the two update rules defined earlier.
- *(Optionally, we might decide to stop iterating, if we realize that the values of  $a$  and  $b$  are no longer changing. This is called **early stopping**, and is typically implemented by tracking the changes on each iteration. Typically, we could decide to break the GD loop if the changes on both parameters  $a$  and  $b$  are less than a given threshold  $\delta$ .)*

```

1 def gradient_descent_linreg(a_0, b_0, x, y, alpha = 1e-5, delta = 1e-5, max_count = 1000):
2     # Define the initial values of a and b as a_0 and b_0
3     a, b = a_0, b_0
4     # Define N as the number of elements in the dataset
5     N = len(x)
6     # Keep track of how much a and b changed on each iteration
7     change = float("Inf")
8     # Counter as safety to prevent infinite looping
9     counter = 0
10    # List of losses, to be used for display later
11    losses = []
12    while change > delta:
13        # Helper to visualize iterations of while loop
14        print("-----")
15        # Use gradient descent update rules for a and b
16        D_a = -2/N*(sum([x_i*(y_i - (a*x_i + b)) for x_i, y_i in zip(x, y)]))
17        D_b = -2/N*(sum([(y_i - (a*x_i + b)) for x_i, y_i in zip(x, y)]))
18        a = a - alpha*D_a
19        b = b - alpha*D_b
20        print("Gradients: ", D_a, D_b)
21        print("New values for (a, b): ", a, b)
22        # Compute change
23        change = max(abs(alpha*D_a), abs(alpha*D_b))
24        print("Change: ", change)
25        # Compute and display current loss
26        loss = loss_mse(a, b, x, y)
27        losses.append(float(loss))
28        print("Loss: ", loss)
29        # Counter update, will break if iterations number exceeds max_count,
30        # to prevent gradient descent from going indefinitely.
31        # (Just a safety measure, for good practice, we would definitely prefer to see
32        # the while loop break "naturally", because change eventually fell under the threshold stop.)
33        counter += 1
34        if(counter > max_count):
35            print("Maximal number of iterations reached.")
36            break
37    return a, b, losses

```

Initialize a and b as you please.



```

1 def gradient_descent_linreg(a_0, b_0, x, y, alpha = 1e-5, delta = 1e-5, max_count = 1000):
2     # Define the initial values of a and b as a_0 and b_0
3     a, b = a_0, b_0
4     # Define N as the number of elements in the dataset
5     N = len(x)
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16        D_a = -2/N*(sum([x_i*(y_i - (a*x_i + b)) for x_i, y_i in zip(x, y)]))
17        D_b = -2/N*(sum([(y_i - (a*x_i + b)) for x_i, y_i in zip(x, y)]))
18        a = a - alpha*D_a
19        b = b - alpha*D_b
20        print("Gradients: ", D_a, D_b)
21        print("New values for (a, b): ", a, b)
22        # Compute change
23        change = max(abs(alpha*D_a), abs(alpha*D_b))
24        print("Change: ", change)
25        # Compute and display current loss
26        loss = loss_mse(a, b, x, y)
27        losses.append(float(loss))
28        print("Loss: ", loss)
29        # Counter update, will break if iterations number exceeds max_count,
30        # to prevent gradient descent from going indefinitely.
31        # (Just a safety measure, for good practice, we would definitely prefer to see
32        # the while loop break "naturally", because change eventually fell under the threshold stop.)
33        counter += 1
34        if(counter > max_count):
35            print("Maximal number of iterations reached.")
36            break
37    return a, b, losses

```

Number of samples in dataset.

```

1 def gradient_descent_linreg(a_0, b_0, x, y, alpha = 1e-5, delta = 1e-5, max_count = 1000):
2     # Define the initial values of a and b as a_0 and b_0
3     a, b = a_0, b_0
4     # Define N as the number of elements in the dataset
5     N = len(x)
6     # Keep track of how much a and b changed on each iteration
7     change = float("Inf")
8     # Counter as safety to prevent infinite looping
9     counter = 0
10    # List of losses, to be used for display later
11    losses = []
12    while change > delta:
13        # Helper to visualize iterations of while loop
14        print("-----")
15        # Use gradient descent update rules for a and b
16        D_a = -2/N*(sum([x_i*(y_i - (a*x_i + b)) for x_i, y_i in zip(x, y)]))
17        D_b = -2/N*(sum([(y_i - (a*x_i + b)) for x_i, y_i in zip(x, y)]))
18        a = a - alpha*D_a
19        b = b - alpha*D_b
20        print("Gradients: ", D_a, D_b)
21        print("New values for (a, b): ", a, b)
22        # Compute change
23        change = max(abs(alpha*D_a), abs(alpha*D_b))
24        print("Change: ", change)
25        # Compute and display current loss
26        loss = loss_mse(a, b, x, y)
27        losses.append(float(loss))
28        print("Loss: ", loss)
29        # Counter update, will break if iterations number exceeds max_count,
30        # to prevent gradient descent from going indefinitely.
31        # (Just a safety measure, for good practice, we would definitely prefer to see
32        # the while loop break "naturally", because change eventually fell under the threshold stop.)
33        counter += 1
34        if(counter > max_count):
35            print("Maximal number of iterations reached.")
36            break
37    return a, b, losses

```

Two possible stopping conditions,  $\text{change} < \text{delta}$  or  $\text{counter} > \text{max\_count}$ .

```

1 def gradient_descent_linreg(a_0, b_0, x, y, alpha = 1e-5, delta = 1e-5, max_count = 1000):
2     # Define the initial values of a and b as a_0 and b_0
3     a, b = a_0, b_0
4     # Define N as the number of elements in the dataset
5     N = len(x)
6     # Keep track of how much a and b changed on each iteration
7     change = float("Inf")
8     # Counter as safety to prevent infinite looping
9     counter = 0
10    # List of losses, to be used for display later
11    losses = []
12    while change > delta:
13        # Helper to visualize iterations of while loop
14        print("-----")
15        # Use gradient descent update rules for a and b
16        D_a = -2/N*(sum([x_i*(y_i - (a*x_i + b)) for x_i, y_i in zip(x, y)]))
17        D_b = -2/N*(sum([(y_i - (a*x_i + b)) for x_i, y_i in zip(x, y)]))
18        a = a - alpha*D_a
19        b = b - alpha*D_b
20        print("Gradients: ", D_a, D_b)
21        print("New values for (a, b): ", a, b)
22        # Compute change
23        change = max(abs(alpha*D_a), abs(alpha*D_b))
24        print("Change: ", change)
25        # Compute and display current loss
26        loss = loss_mse(a, b, x, y)
27        losses.append(float(loss))
28        print("Loss: ", loss)
29        # Counter update, will break if iterations number exceeds max_count,
30        # to prevent gradient descent from going indefinitely.
31        # (Just a safety measure, for good practice, we would definitely prefer to see
32        # the while loop break "naturally", because change eventually fell under the threshold stop.)
33        counter += 1
34        if(counter > max_count):
35            print("Maximal number of iterations reached.")
36            break
37    return a, b, losses

```

Update using our  
GD update rules  
from earlier.

```

1 def gradient_descent_linreg(a_0, b_0, x, y, alpha = 1e-5, delta = 1e-5, max_count = 1000):
2     # Define the initial values of a and b as a_0 and b_0
3     a, b = a_0, b_0
4     # Define N as the number of elements in the dataset
5     N = len(x)
6     # Keep track of how much a and b changed on each iteration
7     change = float("Inf")
8     # Counter as safety to prevent infinite looping
9     counter = 0
10    # List of losses, to be used for display later
11    losses = []
12    while change > delta:
13        # Helper to visualize iterations of while loop
14        print("-----")
15        # Use gradient descent update rules for a and b
16        D_a = -2/N*(sum([x_i*(y_i - (a*x_i + b)) for x_i, y_i in zip(x, y)]))
17        D_b = -2/N*(sum([(y_i - (a*x_i + b)) for x_i, y_i in zip(x, y)]))
18        a = a - alpha*D_a
19        b = b - alpha*D_b
20        print("Gradients: ", D_a, D_b)
21        print("New values for (a, b): ", a, b)
22        # Compute change
23        change = max(abs(alpha*D_a), abs(alpha*D_b))
24        print("Change: ", change)
25        # Compute and display current loss
26        loss = loss_mse(a, b, x, y)
27        losses.append(float(loss))
28        print("Loss: ", loss)
29        # Counter update, will break if iterations number exceeds max_count,
30        # to prevent gradient descent from going indefinitely.
31        # (Just a safety measure, for good practice, we would definitely prefer to see
32        # the while loop break "naturally", because change eventually fell under the threshold stop.)
33        counter += 1
34        if(counter > max_count):
35            print("Maximal number of iterations reached.")
36            break
37    return a, b, losses

```

Compute change on this iteration (to decide on early stopping if changes become insignificant).

```

1 def gradient_descent_linreg(a_0, b_0, x, y, alpha = 1e-5, delta = 1e-5, max_count = 1000):
2     # Define the initial values of a and b as a_0 and b_0
3     a, b = a_0, b_0
4     # Define N as the number of elements in the dataset
5     N = len(x)
6     # Keep track of how much a and b changed on each iteration
7     change = float("Inf")
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13        # Helper to visualize iterations of while loop
14        print("-----")
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16        D_a = -2/N*(sum([x_i*(y_i - (a*x_i + b)) for x_i, y_i in zip(x, y)]))
17        D_b = -2/N*(sum([(y_i - (a*x_i + b)) for x_i, y_i in zip(x, y)]))
18        a = a - alpha*D_a
19        b = b - alpha*D_b
20        print("Gradients: ", D_a, D_b)
21        print("New values for (a, b): ", a, b)
22        # Compute change
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26        loss = loss_mse(a, b, x, y)
27        losses.append(float(loss))
28        print("Loss: ", loss)
29        # Counter update, will break if iterations number exceeds max_count,
30        # to prevent gradient descent from going indefinitely.
31        # (Just a safety measure, for good practice, we would definitely prefer to see
32        # the while loop break "naturally", because change eventually fell under the threshold stop.)
33        counter += 1
34        if(counter > max_count):
35            print("Maximal number of iterations reached.")
36            break
37    return a, b, losses

```

Calculate new MSE value using the new parameters of a and b. We also keep track of these loss values by adding them to a list, used for display later.



```

1 def gradient_descent_linreg(a_0, b_0, x, y, alpha = 1e-5, delta = 1e-5, max_count = 1000):
2     # Define the initial values of a and b as a_0 and b_0
3     a, b = a_0, b_0
4     # Define N as the number of elements in the dataset
5     N = len(x)
6     # Keep track of how much a and b changed on each iteration
7     change = float("Inf")
8     # Counter as safety to prevent infinite looping
9     counter = 0
10    # List of losses, to be used for display later
11    losses = []
12    while change > delta:
13        # Helper to visualize iterations of while loop
14        print("-----")
15        # Use gradient descent update rules for a and b
16        D_a = -2/N*(sum([x_i*(y_i - (a*x_i + b)) for x_i, y_i in zip(x, y)]))
17        D_b = -2/N*(sum([(y_i - (a*x_i + b)) for x_i, y_i in zip(x, y)]))
18        a = a - alpha*D_a
19        b = b - alpha*D_b
20        print("Gradients: ", D_a, D_b)
21        print("New values for (a, b): ", a, b)
22        # Compute change
23        change = max(abs(alpha*D_a), abs(alpha*D_b))
24        print("Change: ", change)
25        # Compute and display current loss
26        loss = loss_mse(a, b, x, y)
27        losses.append(float(loss))
28        print("Loss: ", loss)
29        # Counter update, will break if iterations number exceeds max_count,
30        # to prevent gradient descent from going indefinitely.
31        # (Just a safety measure, for good practice, we would definitely prefer to see
32        # the while loop break "naturally", because change eventually fell under the threshold stop.)
33        counter += 1
34        if(counter > max_count):
35            print("Maximal number of iterations reached.")
36            break
37    return a, b, losses

```

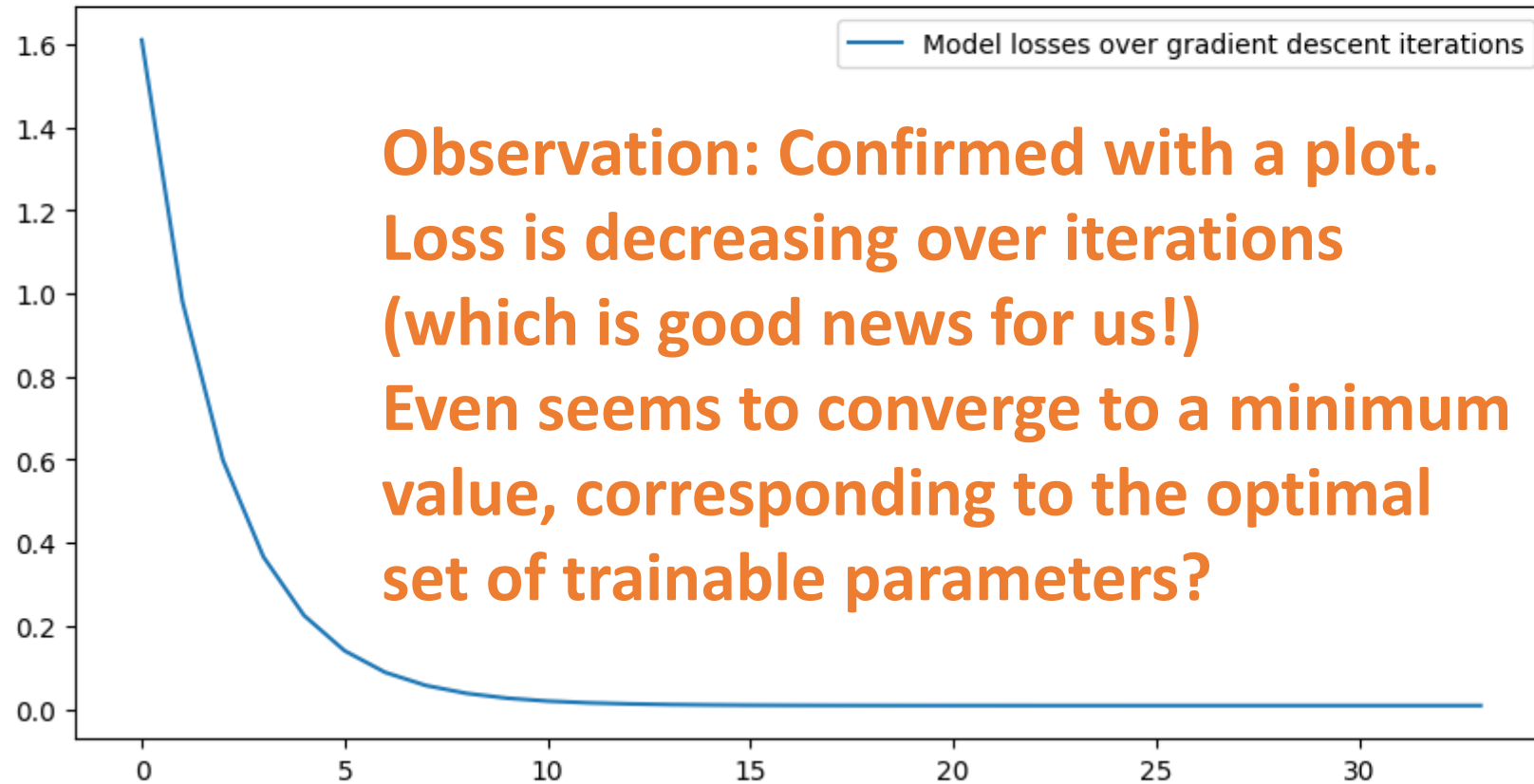
Return trained parameters and  
loss values list on each iteration.

```
: 1 a_gd, b_gd, losses = gradient_descent_linreg(a_0 = 0, b_0 = 0, x = inputs, y = outputs, alpha = 1e-5, delta = 1e-6)
```

```
-----  
Gradients: -342.3996226384001 3.105429920000001  
New values for (a, b): 0.0034239962263840013 -3.105429920000001e-05  
Change: 0.0034239962263840013  
Loss: 1.61e+00  
-----  
Gradients: -266.62829357559235 2.4212214483389536  
New values for (a, b): 0.006090279162139925 -5.526651368338955e-05  
Change: 0.0026662829357559236  
Loss: 9.82e-01  
-----  
Gradients: -207.62478780001163 1.8884249597020164  
New values for (a, b): 0.008166527040140042 -7.415076328040972e-05  
Change: 0.0020762478780001164  
Loss: 5.99e-01  
-----  
Gradients: -161.6784683033283 1.4735337252735503  
New values for (a, b): 0.009783311723173324 -8.888610053314522e-05  
Change: 0.001616784683033283
```

**Observation: Loss is decreasing over iterations  
(which is good news for us!)**

```
1 # Display dataset
2 plt.figure(figsize = (10, 5))
3 plt.plot(losses, label = "Model losses over gradient descent iterations")
4
5 # Display
6 plt.legend(loc = 'best')
7 plt.show()
```





# Checking for optimal parameters

We have generated the dataset ourselves, so we know the optimal values for  $a$  and  $b$ ! (And we can even compute using the normal equation anyway...)

```
1 print("Optimal a_star value: ", a_star)
2 print("Value for a_star, found by gradient descent: ", a_gd)
3 print("We used 14373/1000000 in the mock dataset generation, which is: ", 14373/1000000)
4 print("Optimal b_star value: ", b_star)
5 print("Value for b_star, found by gradient descent: ", b_gd)
6 print("The value we used in the mock dataset generation: ", 100000/1000000)
```

Optimal a\_star value: 0.014844435285058159

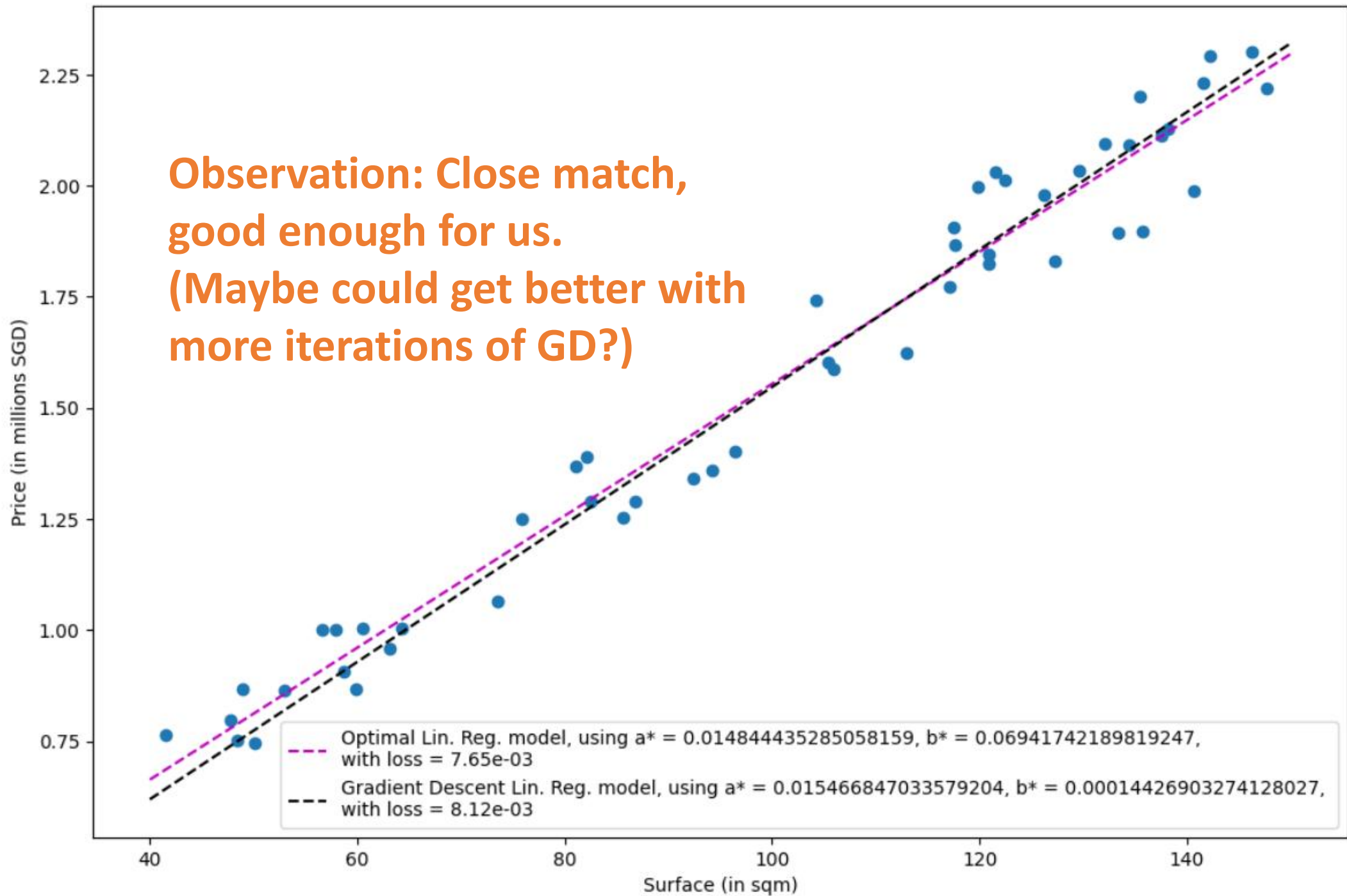
Value for a\_star, found by gradient descent: 0.015466847033579204

We used 14373/1000000 in the mock dataset generation, which is: 0.014373

Optimal b\_star value: 0.06941742189819247

Value for b\_star, found by gradient descent: 0.00014426903274128027

The value we used in the mock dataset generation: 0.1



# Using Sklearn for Linear regression

In practice, we never implement the linear regression model ourselves (but like many other things in CS, it is a good practice to try it once!)

- It is often better/faster to rely on the **sklearn** library and use the **LinearRegression** object!

```
1 # Creating a sklearn Linear Regression model.
2 # It uses the same analytical formula from earlier, i.e.  $W^* = (X^T X)^{-1} X^T Y$ .
3 reg = LinearRegression().fit(sk_inputs, sk_outputs)
4 # The coefficients for  $a^*$  and  $b^*$  are found using coeff_ and intercept_ respectively.
5 a_sk = reg.coef_[0]
6 b_sk = reg.intercept_
7 print("Optimal a_star value: ", a_star)
8 print("Value for a_star, found by sklearn: ", a_sk)
9 print("Optimal b_star value: ", b_star)
10 print("Value for b_star, found by sklearn: ", b_sk)
```

Optimal a\_star value: 0.014844435285058159

Value for a\_star, found by sklearn: 0.014844435285058166

Optimal b\_star value: 0.06941742189819247

Value for b\_star, found by sklearn: 0.06941742189818956

# Predicting using Linear Regression

After training, it is also good practice to check if the predictor makes sense, by **testing** it and asking it to predict the price of an apartment it has never seen before.

- Confirm the pertinence of predicted values manually, if possible.

```
1 # We can later use this Linear Regression model, to predict the price of
2 # a new apartment with surface 105 sqm (price in millions SGD).
3 new_surf = 105
4 pred_price = reg.predict(np.array([[new_surf]]))[0]
5 print(pred_price)
```

1.628083126829297

```
1 avg_price = 14373*new_surf + 100000
2 min_val = 0.9*avg_price
3 max_val = 1.1*avg_price
4 print("Min, max, avg prices: ", [min_val, max_val, avg_price])
```

Min, max, avg prices: [1448248.5, 1770081.5000000002, 1609165]

# Let us call it a break for today

We will continue on the next lecture with more reminders  
*(Bonus slides after this)*

# More specifically

Specific topics in **linear algebra** to focus on:

- **Vectors, dot product, norms of vectors**
- **Matrices and their properties: determinant, rank, norm, trace, transpose**
- **Matrix multiplication and inversion**
- **Solving systems of linear equations**
- **Eigenvectors and eigenvalues**
- **Projections and orthonormality**
- (Symmetric matrices, positive semi-definite matrices)
- (Matrix decompositions, e.g. LU decomposition, SVD)

# More specifically

Specific topics in **calculus** to focus on:

- **Logarithmic and exponential functions**
- **Derivatives and partial derivatives, the chain rule of derivatives**
- (Integrals basics)
- **Multivariate calculus: functions of vectors and matrices and their gradients.**
- (Jacobian and Hessian)
- **Equations of lines and hyperplanes**
- **Solving optimization problems with Gradient Descent, Lagrange multipliers, and other methods.**

# More specifically

Specific topics in **probabilities and statistics** to focus on:

- **Probability rules and axioms, random variables (both discrete and continuous)**
- **Standard distributions (Bernoulli, Binomial, Multinomial, Uniform and Gaussian)**
- **Expectation, variance, covariance and correlation**
- **Conditional probability, Bayes' theorem**
- (Law of total probability)
- (Joint and marginal probability distributions)
- **The central limit theorem**



# Installing PyTorch and CUDA

- Check if your GPU is in the list of acceptable GPUs.  
<https://developer.nvidia.com/cuda-gpus>
- If so, install CUDA (check that you CUDA version number matches the one of your PyTorch install!)  
<https://developer.nvidia.com/cuda-downloads>

### Select Target Platform

Click on the green buttons that describe your target platform. Only supported platforms will be shown. By downloading and using the software, you agree to fully comply with the terms and conditions of the [CUDA EULA](#).

|                  |             |               |             |             |             |
|------------------|-------------|---------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|
| Operating System | Linux       | Windows       |             |             |             |
| Architecture     | x86_64      |               |             |             |             |
| Version          | 10          | 11            | Server 2016 | Server 2019 | Server 2022 |
| Installer Type   | exe (local) | exe (network) |             |             |             |

# Installing PyTorch and CUDA

**Question:** How to use CUDA with MacOS?

Efforts are being made to make GPU computing compatible with AMD and MacOS GPUs, but not the best (afaik).

## Select Target Platform

Click on the green buttons that describe your target platform. Only supported platforms will be shown. By down terms and conditions of the [CUDA EULA](#).

### Operating System

[Linux](#)[Windows](#)

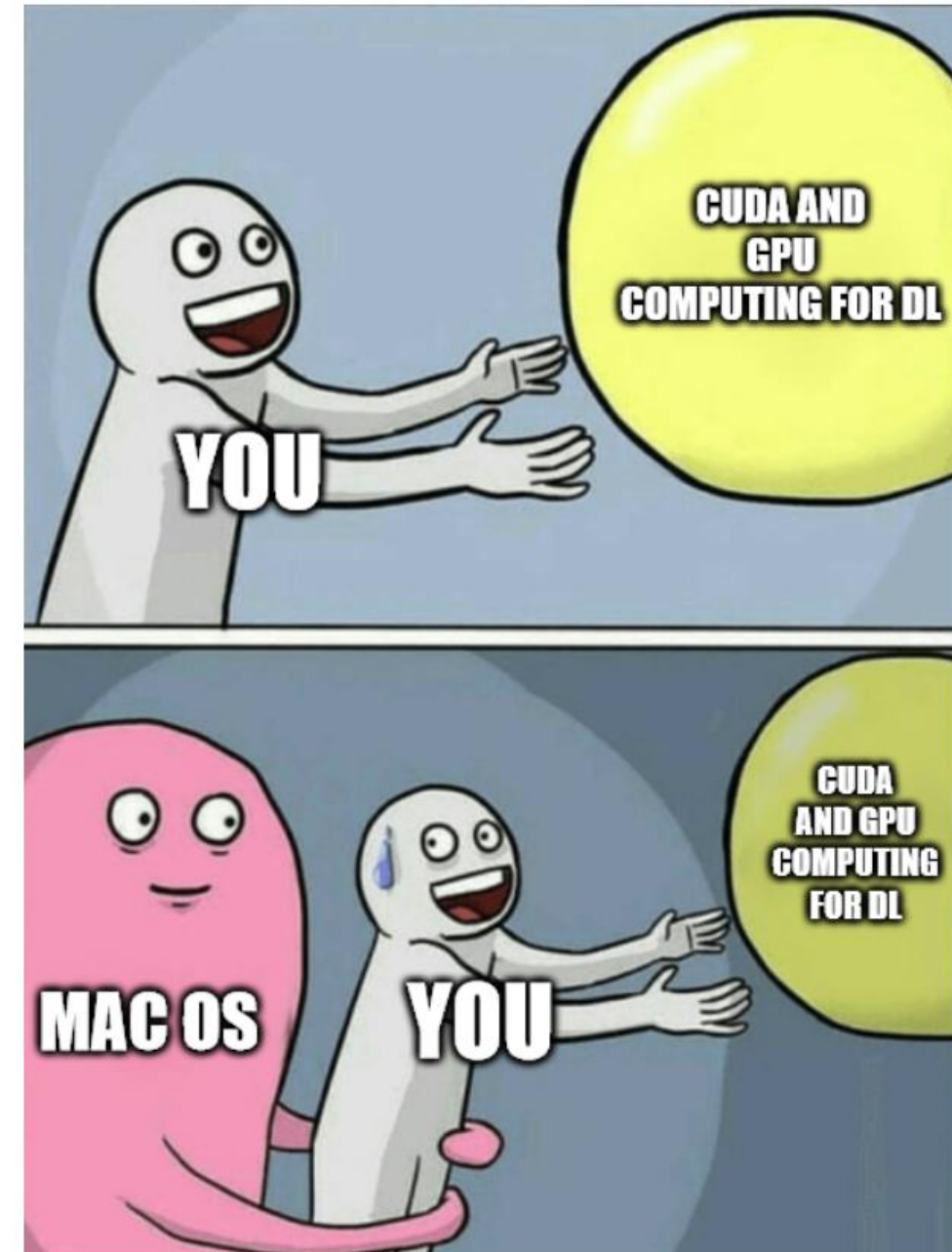
### Architecture

[x86\\_64](#)

### Version

[10](#)[11](#)[Server 2016](#)[Server 2019](#)[Server 2022](#)

### Installer Type

[exe \(local\)](#)[exe \(network\)](#)

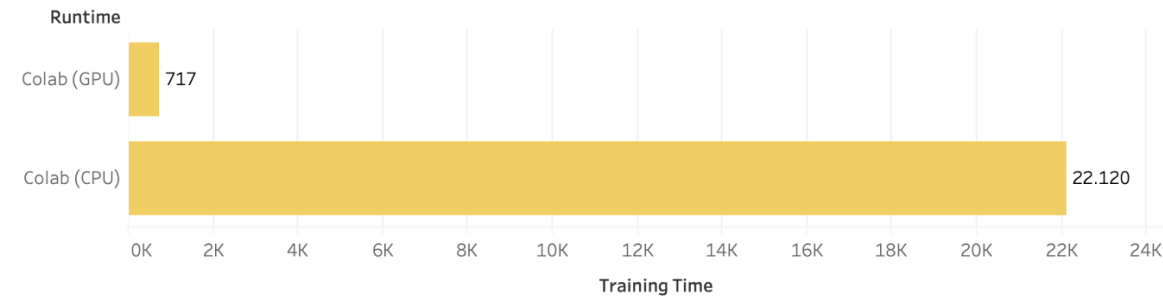
# Installing PyTorch and CUDA

Your GPU not in the list of CUDA-enabled GPUs?

You bought a MacOS laptop?

- **All notebooks can run on CPU (but they might take significantly longer to run).**
- Also, always the option of using **Google Colab**, or create an education account on AWS.

CPU vs GPU Training Time Comparison in Seconds



# Checking your PyTorch and CUDA install

- **Hello World for PyTorch:** to check you have PyTorch installed correctly. The code below should run and display a tensor.

```
import torch
x = torch.rand(5, 3)
print(x)
```

```
tensor([[0.3380, 0.3845, 0.3217],
        [0.8337, 0.9050, 0.2650],
        [0.2979, 0.7141, 0.9069],
        [0.1449, 0.1132, 0.1375],
        [0.4675, 0.3947, 0.1426]])
```

- **Hello World for CUDA:** to check you have correctly installed CUDA on top of PyTorch. The code below should print *True*, as the output of `torch.cuda.is_available()`

```
import torch
torch.cuda.is_available()
```

# A quick word about PyTorch 2.0

**PyTorch v2.0** is the current (latest version released in March 2023).

- Should be fully retro-compatible.
- Revising and testing notebooks (they were designed last year and tested on v1.13).
- Kindly let me know if you have any issues!
- Will let you know about new v2.0 features on W13.



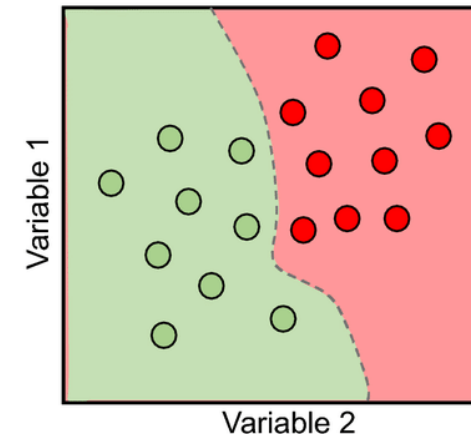
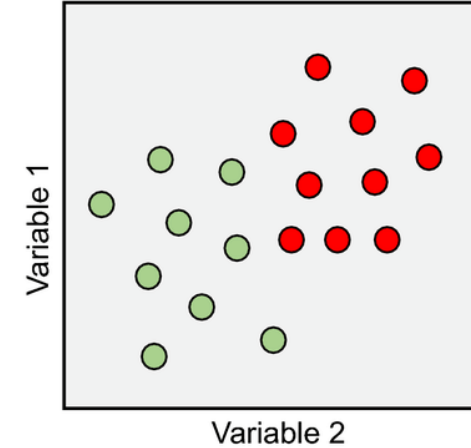
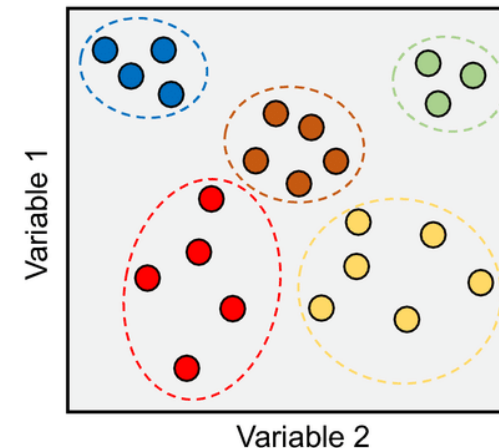
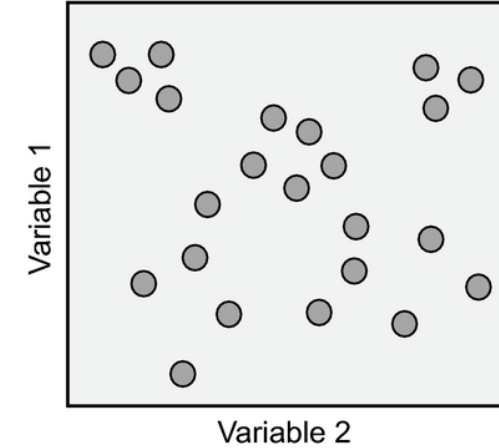
# Supervised vs Unsupervised Learning

## Definition (Supervised vs. Unsupervised Learning):

**Supervised** and **Unsupervised Learning** are the two techniques of ML.

The main difference is **the need for labelled training data**:

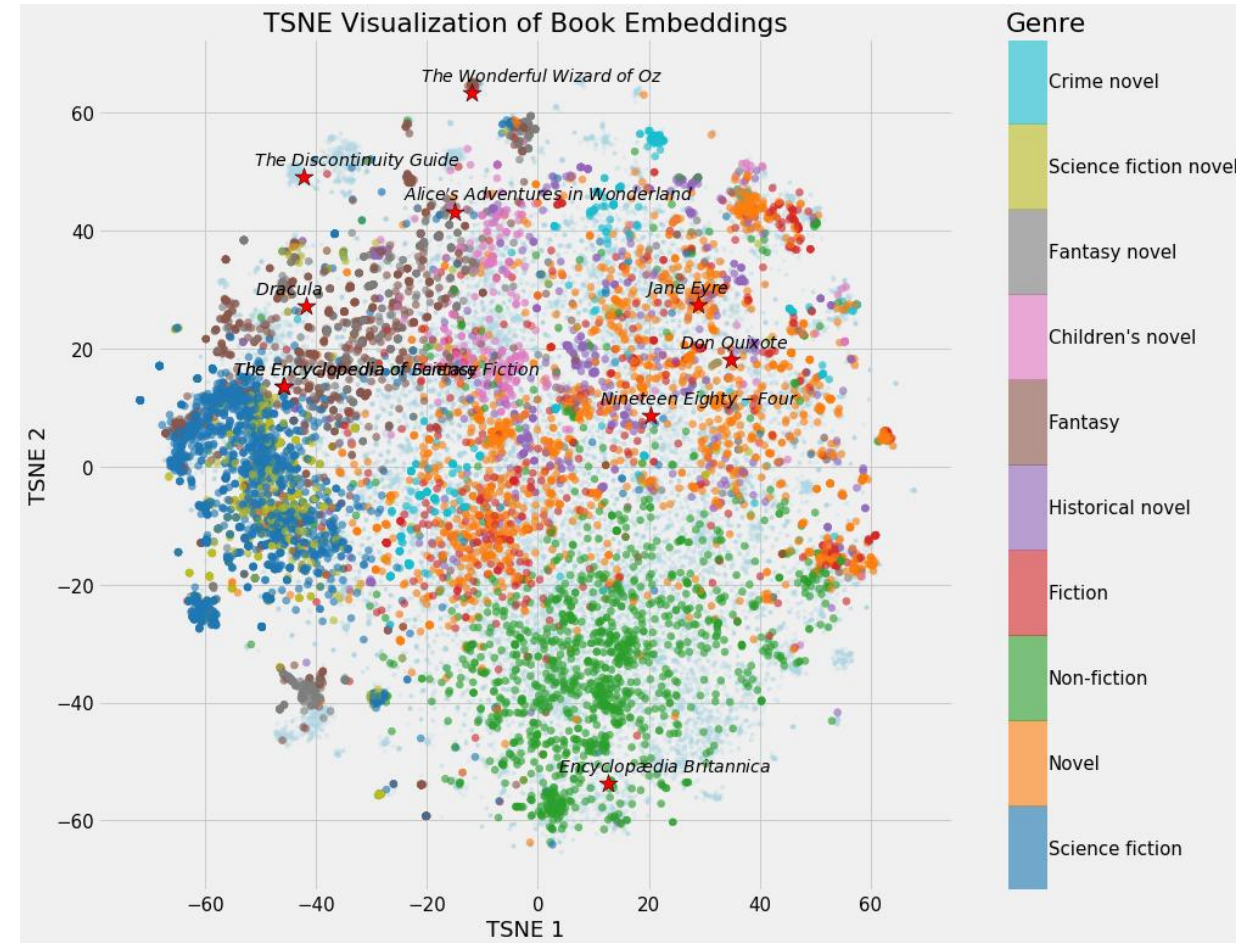
- Supervised machine learning relies on labelled input and output data to learn and make predictions,
- while **unsupervised learning does not require labelled data**.





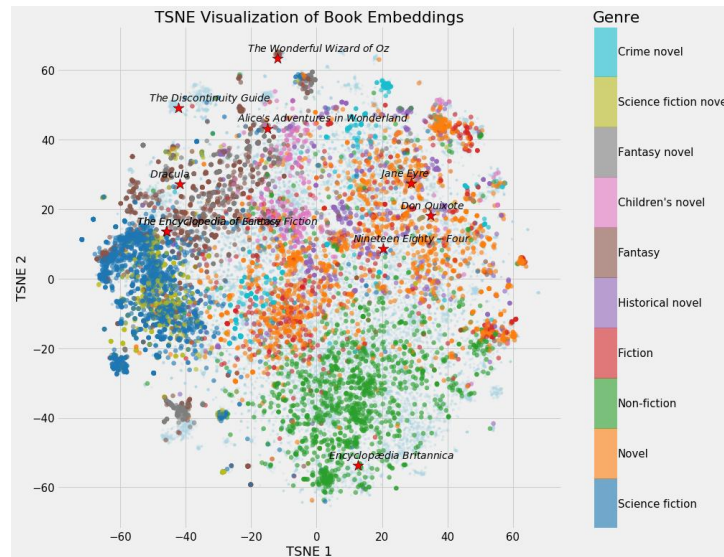
# Unsupervised Learning Examples

- Examples of **unsupervised learning**: clustering customers based on their behaviours, segmenting images, and identifying topics in a document.

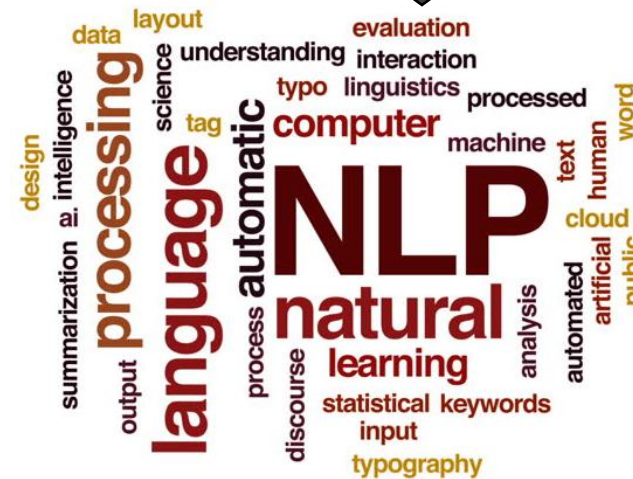


# Unsupervised Learning Examples

- Examples of **unsupervised learning**: clustering customers based on their behaviours, segmenting images, and identifying topics in a document.



Identify topics that seem to appear in those papers and their prominence



## TYPES OF ML / NLP PAPERS

HERE'S A NEW TASK WHERE OUR MODELS DON'T SUCCEED JUST YET

NEVER MIND. TURNS OUT WITH SOME CLEVER TRICKS, WE ALREADY GET SUPER-HUMAN PERFORMANCE

WE COMBINED TWO WELL-KNOWN TECHNIQUES IN AN UNSURPRISING WAY

TRANSFORMERS ALSO WORK ON THIS TYPE OF DATA

A TASK-SPECIFIC IMPROVEMENT THAT MAY OR MAY NOT WORK ON YOUR DATA

THIS SIMPLE TRICK IS ALL YOU NEED

NEURAL NETWORKS ARE LIKE THE BRAIN IN THIS SPECIFIC WAY, WHICH SLIGHTLY HELPS FOR OUR TASK

GOOD LUCK RUNNING A STATISTICAL SIGNIFICANCE TEST ON OUR RESULTS

CHECK OUT THESE NICE CHERRY-PICKED SAMPLES OF OUR MODEL

WE USED LOTS OF COMPUTE TO TRAIN A SLIGHTLY BETTER LANGUAGE MODEL

SOME THOUGHTS ON WHY THE WAY WE DO THINGS IS WRONG

DID YOU KNOW THAT OUR MODELS FAIL ON X?



# Clustering vs. Association (Unsupervised)

## Definition (**Clustering vs. Association**):

Unsupervised learning can be used for two types of problems: **Clustering** and **Association**.

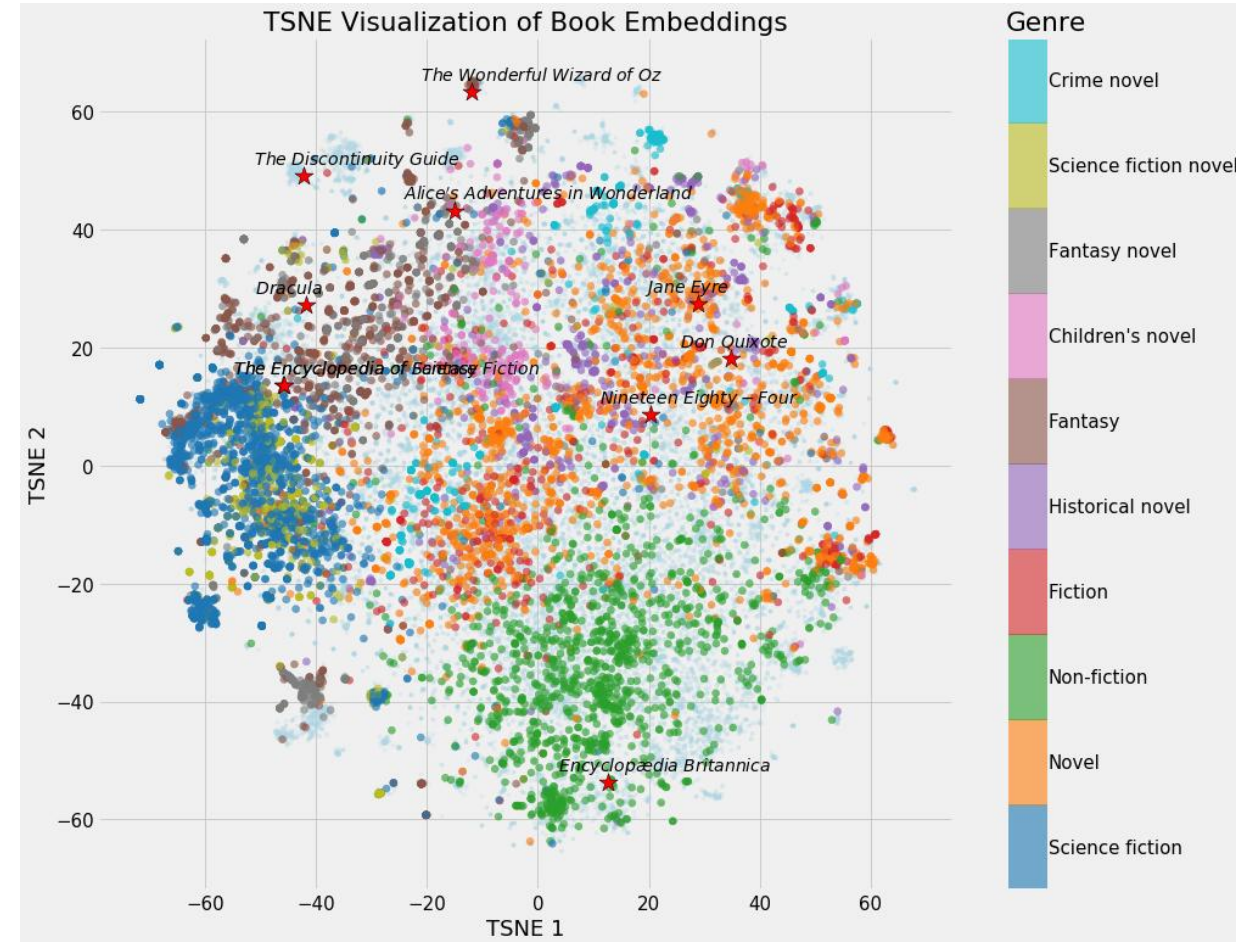
The main difference is that

- **clustering** groups data based on similarity,
- while **association** looks for relationships between variables.

# Clustering vs. Association (Unsupervised)

## Examples of clustering:

- Group customers into clusters based on the similarities in their purchasing behaviours, such as their spending habits or types of products they like.
- Group the catalogue of movies available on Netflix and identify what movies have in common, so you can later recommend a movie to a user based on what he/she has seen before.



# Clustering vs. Association (Unsupervised)

## Example of association:

- Finding the relationship between customer buying behaviors and customer satisfaction.
- Association can be used to understand how changes in customer behavior impacts customer satisfaction, such as if buying a certain product increases customer satisfaction (or the opposite).

Customer Satisfaction Survey on McDVoice.com

Español

Welcome to the McDonald's Customer Satisfaction Survey on McDVoice.com.

[Load Accessibility Friendly Version](#)

We value your candid feedback and appreciate you taking the time to complete our survey.

① To begin, please enter the 26-digit Survey Code located in the middle of your receipt.

-  -  -  -  -

**Start**

Survey code:  
99999-01010-61515-20238-00032-2  
2111 McDonald's Drive  
Oak Brook  
IL  
60513  
!!! THANK YOU !!!  
TEL# 312-555-5555 Store# 88710

KS# 1 Jun.15'15 (Mon) 20:23  
MFY SIDE 1 KVS Order 01  
QTY ITEM TOTAL  
1 Egg McMuffin 2.99  
Subtotal 2.99



# Proof of the Normal Equation

Using the notations

$$X = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & x_1 \\ \dots & \dots \\ 1 & x_N \end{pmatrix},$$

$$Y = \begin{pmatrix} y_1 \\ \dots \\ y_N \end{pmatrix},$$

$$W^* = \begin{pmatrix} b^* \\ a^* \end{pmatrix}$$

We have, in matrix form

$$XW^* = \begin{pmatrix} a^*x_1 + b^* \\ \dots \\ a^*x_N + b^* \end{pmatrix}$$

And, then it follows that

$$XW^* - Y = \begin{pmatrix} a^*x_1 + b^* - y_1 \\ \dots \\ a^*x_N + b^* - y_N \end{pmatrix}$$

# Proof of the Normal Equation

Our loss function, the MSE  $L$ , is therefore defined, in matrix format as:

$$L = \frac{1}{N} (XW^* - Y)^T (XW^* - Y)$$

This is equivalent to

$$L = \frac{1}{N} ((XW^*)^T - Y^T)(XW^* - Y)$$

# Proof of the Normal Equation

We then get

$$L = \frac{1}{N} (W^{*T} X^T - Y^T) (XW^* - Y)$$

Expanding

$$L = \frac{1}{N} (W^{*T} X^T X W^* - Y^T X W^* - W^{*T} X^T Y + Y^T Y)$$

# Proof of the Normal Equation

Recall that we are trying to find the solution to optimization problem

$$(a^*, b^*) = \arg \min_{a, b} [L(a, b, x, y)]$$

With

$$L = \frac{1}{N} (W^{*T} X^T X W^* - Y^T X W^* - W^{*T} X^T Y + Y^T Y)$$

Recognizing that  $Y^T X W^* = W^{*T} X^T Y$ , differentiating our function  $L$  with respect to  $W$  and equating it to zero gives:

$$\frac{\partial L}{\partial W} = \frac{1}{N} (2X^T X W - 2X^T Y) = 0$$



# Proof of the Normal Equation

This is equivalent to

$$(X^T X W^* - X^T Y) = 0$$

Or,

$$X^T X W^* = X^T Y$$

**Assuming  $X^T X$  is invertible** (and that might not always be the case based on your dataset!), this finally gives:

$$W^* = (X^T X)^{-1} X^T Y$$